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BLEND OF ARTISTIC IMPRESSIONS AND ACTUAL SHOT

OTHER NEWS OF THE DAY



Delhi's New Gateways: Lion, Boat & Arches

NEW DELHI A 'Make in India' lion, a boat-like structure and sweeping arches will greet visitors at Delhi's borders, with gateways proposed at Apsara, Loni and Noida-Mayur Vihar. Delhi Tourism and Transportation Development Corporation has proposed building gateways at entry points at the city's Noida-Mayur Vihar, Dilshad Garden-Apsara border and Loni border. The move follows a similar plan for border entry points at Kapashera, Auchandi, Arjanagarh and Dhansa at ₹39.90 crore. —PTI



Hosp Violence: Maha MLA Son in Cops' Custody

PALGHAR Twenty-two persons arrested in the Palghar hospital violence case were remanded in police custody till September 16 by a local court. Those remanded in custody by magistrate Yogesh Gajbihiye in an order issued late Sunday night include MLA Rajendra Gavit's son Rohit Gavit and former Shiv Sena district chief Kundan Sankhe. On the intervening night of September 5 and 6, Sena workers barged into Relief Hospital at Palghar where a few injured 'Govindas' who had participated in the Dahi Handi celebrations had been admitted. —PTI



Guj Cops Bust Bomb Threat Syndicate

AHMEDABAD Gujarat Police has busted an inter-state syndicate allegedly involved in sending bomb threat emails to government offices, educational institutions and courts, and arrested two persons from Bihar and Jharkhand. The investigation showed that the accused allegedly received financial support from associates in Bangladesh and cryptocurrency wallets were used for financial transactions. The probe was launched after an email was received on September 10 at the email ID of Gujarat government's legislative and parliamentary affairs department. —PTI

Poliloquy R PRASAD



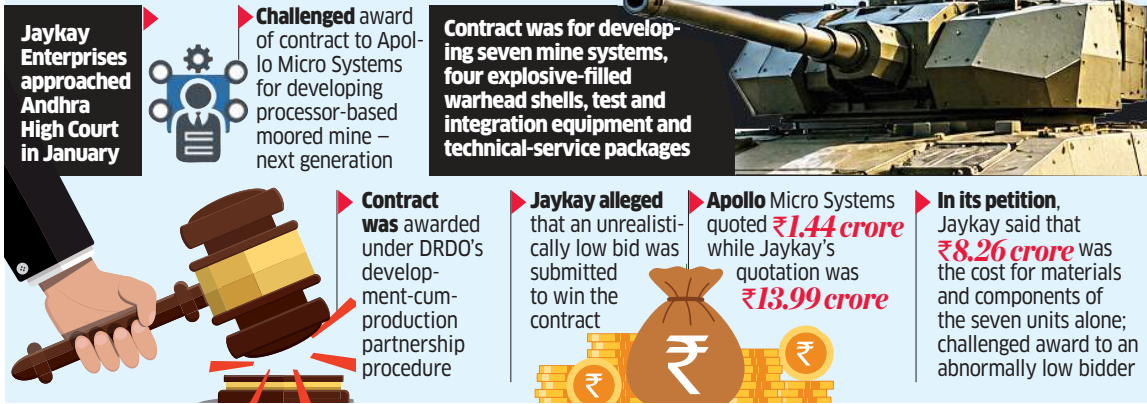
VERDICT CAN HAVE FAR-REACHING CONSEQUENCES; COURT SCRUTINISES DCPD AWARD

HC Orders Review of ₹1, Other Extremely Low Defence Bids

Manu Pubby

New Delhi: In a ruling that can have far-reaching consequences for the defence industry, the Andhra Pradesh High Court has held that contracts cannot be mechanically awarded to the lowest bidder when the quoted price is so low that it raises doubts about the company's ability to deliver. Last week, the Andhra Pradesh High Court at Amaravati said that when a bid value is abnormally low, a viability assessment needs to be conducted before the contract is awarded. The court ruling came in a case concerning the development-cum-production partnership (DCPP) model of the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO), under which companies are invited to co-develop weapon technologies. Firms are initially invited to bid for a limited development order, typically covering a small number of prototypes. The lowest-ranked bidders selected under the tender then work with DRDO to develop, test and demon-

The 'Abnormally Low Bid' Case



High court finds procedural failure

The record did not show that DRDO completed the required pre-award scrutiny for an 'abnormally low bid' under clause 6.42(b) (ii) of DRDO Procurement Manual, 2025

DRDO has been asked to independently examine whether the bid is genuinely executable at the offered price before finalising the award

strate the system against the stipulated performance requirements. Once the equipment clears the required developmental and user trials and is found fit for operational induction, the armed forces can place larger production orders. Because the initial development phase is limited in quantity but carries high upfront costs, including engineering, trials and certification, companies may be willing to absorb part

of the initial expenditure, or even incur losses, at that stage in the expectation of a larger follow-on order. There have been instances in the

EURASIAN NATURAL RESOURCES IN FOCUS

New Delhi Summit Boosts India-EAEU FTA Negotiations

Next round of talks in November, ahead of PM's Moscow trip for the annual summit

Dipanjani Roy Chaudhury

New Delhi: The negotiations for a free trade agreement (FTA) between the Russia-led Eurasian Economic Union (EAEU) and India picked up momentum last week on the margins of the BRICS summit and the India-Russia Innoport (joint industrial exposition) held here. The next round of negotiations is expected to be held in November, ahead of Prime Minister Narendra Modi's Moscow trip for the annual summit. The November round of negotiations will focus on market access for both sides. Specific tariff decisions will be taken up in future rounds of talks, ET has learnt. This FTA will give India access to the huge natural resources of Eurasia. India and the EAEU, comprising Armenia, Belarus, Kazakhstan, the Kyrgyz Republic and the Russian Federation, signed the terms of reference (ToR) to launch negotiations on an FTA in 2025. With a combined GDP of \$6.5 trillion, the proposed FTA is expected to expand market access for Indian exporters, support diversification into new sectors and geographies, enhance competitiveness against non-market economies and deliver significant benefits to micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs). ToR provides the framework for



COMMITTED TO TALKS

India and EAEU — Armenia, Belarus, Kazakhstan, the Kyrgyz Republic and Russia — signed terms of reference to launch FTA negotiations in 2025

the negotiations and is expected to unlock untapped trade potential, increase investments and establish a stronger and more durable India-EAEU partnership. EAEU was established by the Treaty on the Eurasian Economic Union. EAEU provides for free movement of goods, services, capital and labour, and pursues coordinated, harmonised and unified policies in the sectors determined by the treaty and international agreements within the union.

AS INDIA PLAYS THE ROLE OF A MEDIATOR BETWEEN ABU DHABI AND TEHRAN

Pezeshkian's BRICS Meetings Deliver Strong Message to Pak

Iran Prez's meeting with Abu Dhabi Crown Prince likely to smoothen ties between neighbours

Dipanjani Roy Chaudhury

New Delhi: While all eyes were on Chinese President Xi Jinping's first visit to India in seven years and Russian President Vladimir Putin's unprecedented three-day trip to India, Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian's first visit to New Delhi in his current capacity, amid the ongoing conflict with the US, created considerable buzz. The visible warmth between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Pezeshkian on all three days of the summit, as well as the Iranian President's meetings with various Indian religious leaders, signalled New Delhi's balanced approach to the region and the significance of Iran in India's regional calculus. Modi has been invited by Pezeshkian to visit Tehran. Following his meeting with the Iranian President, the PM wrote on X: "We talked about the India-Iran friendship. We believe that we should move forward with a



Abu Dhabi Crown Prince Sheikh Khalid bin Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan with Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian on the sidelines of BRICS summit

We believe that we should move forward with a long-term and win-win strategy. Iran can not only be a source of crude oil and gas for India, but can also serve as a counterweight to Pakistan and a gateway to Afghanistan, Central Asia and Russia.

Equally significant was the meeting between Abu Dhabi Crown Prince Sheikh Khalid bin Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan and Pezeshkian, which could help lower tensions in the Gulf. The war had

cast a shadow over BRICS in the run-up to the summit, and a joint statement appeared difficult at one point ahead of the summit. As the New Delhi Declaration was issued following intense negotiations by the host, an understanding was reached between the UAE and Iran, with encouragement from other founding members of BRICS. Pezeshkian met the Abu Dhabi Crown Prince here on Saturday night, before the departure of the leader of the Gulf state. While the UAE has been infrequently targeted by Iran over the last three months, the two sides reportedly reached an understanding.

AS NEW DELHI DECLARATION WAS ISSUED AFTER INTENSE NEGOTIATIONS, AN UNDERSTANDING WAS REACHED BETWEEN THE UAE AND IRAN, WITH ENCOURAGEMENT FROM OTHER BRICS MEMBERS

The New Delhi meeting would help smoothen ties between the two neighbours, whose economic and security interests are intertwined. India played the role of a mediator between Abu Dhabi and Tehran. The meeting between the Iranian President and leaders from Kashmir was equally significant as Iran's support to India on the Jammu and Kashmir issue is critical at the Organisation of Islamic Cooperation. The meeting delivered a strong message to Pakistan even as Islamabad tries to position itself as a mediator between the US and Tehran for a peace deal. Iran is engaged with Pakistan in conducting negotiations with the US, but its ties with India are historical and significant.

The most important consensus they (President Xi Jinping & Prime Minister Narendra Modi) reached (on the margins of BRICS summit) was that China & India should be partners

WANG YI Chinese Foreign Minister



Malaysian PM Ibrahim Meets Keralam CM

MALAPPURAM (KERALAM) Malaysian PM Anwar Ibrahim met Keralam CM VD Satheesan at a wellness centre in Chelembra here on Monday, during his stay in the state. Satheesan arrived at the centre by helicopter at around 2.30 pm for the meeting with the Malaysian premier. Satheesan presented a traditional Kathakali-themed memento to the Malaysian PM. Ibrahim had arrived in Keralam to meet prominent Sunni scholar and Indian Grand Mufti Kanthapuram AP Aboobacker Musliyar in Kozhikode on Sunday evening. —PTI

FIR BASED ON DETAILED STATEMENT GIVEN BY SALIAN'S FATHER

CBI FIR in Disha Salian's Death Case Alleges Conspiracy, Cover-up

In line with Bombay High Court's order, no one named as accused

Our Political Bureau

Mumbai: Central Bureau of Investigation has registered an FIR into the death of Bollywood celebrity manager Disha Salian, days after the Bombay High Court ordered a probe by the agency. FIR has been registered on the basis of a detailed statement given by Salian's father, Satish Salian. The agency has invoked various provisions of the erstwhile Indian Penal Code relating to murder, gang rape, causing disappearance of evidence

and offences concerning public servants allegedly framing incorrect records or disobeying legal directions to shield offenders. The FIR does not name anyone as an accused, in line with the high court's order. Satish Salian has alleged a conspiracy followed by a cover-up in connection with his daughter's death. FIR lists several people whose roles, according to his statement, require investigation, including Shiv Sena (UBT) leader Aditya Thackeray, Rohan Roy, Dino Morea, Sooraj Pancholi, Aditya Thackeray's bodyguards, Rhea Chakraborty, Showik Chakraborty, former police officer Sachin Vaze, former

Mumbai police commissioner Param Bir Singh, DCP Vishal Thakur and former Maharashtra CM Uddhav Thackeray, among others. FIR also refers to allegations of the "creation and propagation of the false suicide story" and the "suppression, destruction and/or fabrication of evidence". It further names several police officers, doctors, forensic officials, security guards and members of the special investigation team whose roles have been sought to be examined. Salian, 28, died in June 2020 after reportedly falling from the 14th floor of the Regent Galaxy building in Malad, Mumbai. Her death came five days before the body of actor Sushant Singh Rajput was found at his rented residence in Bandra on June 14. BJP leader Nitesh Rane had alleged that the two deaths were connected.



TO SERVE SENTENCE Tejpal Surrenders Before Goa Court

Press Trust Of India

Panaji: Former Tehelka editor-in-chief Tarun Tejpal surrendered before a Goa court on Monday to serve his 10-year rigorous imprisonment sentence in a 2013 sexual assault case. On August 25, Supreme Court had directed Tejpal to surrender within three weeks to undergo his 10-year prison sentence following his conviction by the Bombay High Court.

"We are in the Supreme Court. We are sure that justice will come," Tejpal said while heading toward jail.

SC had listed his appeal challenging his conviction and sentence for hearing on September 22, subject to the filing of the surrender certificate.

ELECTORAL Battlefield

Raj Polls: BJP Bags 4 of 10 Corps; Cong Blames 'Unfair' Delimitation

JAIPUR The ruling BJP emerged ahead of Congress in Rajasthan's urban body polls on Monday, winning 4,179 wards against the Opposition party's 3,613 and securing clear majorities in four of the state's 10 municipal corporations. Congress secured majority in Bikaner corporation and scored a major victory in municipal council in Jhalawar, considered a stronghold of former CM Vasundhara Raje. Independents emerged as a major force by winning 2,273 wards and dominating the verdict in municipal corporation in Bharatpur, the hometown of chief minister Bhajanlal Sharma, where they bagged 36 of the 65 wards. —PTI

Parkash Singh Badal's Cousin Joins Punjab BJP Ahead of Elections

CHANDIGARH Major Bhupinder Singh Dhillion (ret'd), cousin of former Punjab chief minister and Akali patriarch, the late Parkash Singh Badal, joined BJP in the presence of Haryana CM Nayab Singh Saini and Punjab BJP president Kewal Singh Dhillion here on Monday. Dhillion served as Badal's political secretary for 25 years. His father, late Gurraj Singh Dhillion, served as a Rajya Sabha member from 1952 to 1958, representing the Shiromani Akali Dal, and played an important role in Badal's early political journey, according to a BJP statement. The Haryana CM welcomed Dhillion and his son Amarveer Singh into BJP. —PTI

Congress Names Sibamoni Bora for Nagaon Bypoll

GUWAHATI Congress on Monday named former MLA Sibamoni Bora as its candidate for the upcoming bypoll to the Nagaon Lok Sabha constituency in Assam. The byelection is scheduled for October 6, and counting of votes will take place on October 9. "Congress President Mallikarjun Kharge has approved the candidature of Sibamoni Bora, ex-MLA, as party candidate to contest the ensuing byelection to the Lok Sabha from Nagaon parliamentary constituency of Assam," AICC general secretary KC Venugopal said in a statement. Bora was an MLA from the Batadrava legislative seat in Nagaon from 2021 to 2026. —PTI

‘VANDE MATARAM NOT AN ORDINARY SONG, IT AWAKENED INDIAN CONSCIOUSNESS’

Mother Tongue Key to a Child’s Complete Development: Shah

Hindi dictionary, which began with 51,000 words, now has 800,000 words: Shah at Hindi Diwas 2026

Rahul Tripathi

New Delhi: Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Monday said ‘Vande Mataram’ is not an ordinary song. “It was Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay’s great effort to awaken Indian consciousness during a period of intense colonial subjugation. Through his poetry, he sought to shake the sleeping consciousness of India,” he said while speaking at ‘Hindi Diwas 2026’ and the 6th All India Official Language Conference in Mumbai.

WHETHER IT IS JEE, NEET OR AN UNDERGRADUATE ENTRANCE EXAMINATION, THESE EXAMINATIONS ARE NOW CONDUCTED IN 13 LANGUAGES.

“Vande Mataram written in ‘Anandamath’, soon became a declaration of freedom throughout India. Unfortunately, ‘Vande Mataram’ was later divided into parts. Even after Independence, it took Parliament nearly 80 years to accept it in its complete form. PM Modi is the leader who took the initiative to have ‘Vande Mataram’ sung again at official functions in its complete form and with full glory,” he said. Shah said the Hindi Diwas programme being held in the land of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj during the 150th year of ‘Vande Mataram’ would take forward the journey of the

official language and Indian languages in the coming days.

The Department of Official Language has achieved numerous milestones, he said. One of the biggest initiatives was undertaken through the National Education Policy (NEP). PM has made learning one’s mother tongue in primary education mandatory. No child can grow into a complete individual without learning his or her mother tongue because the affection of a mother and the love of a sister or brother cannot be fully understood without one’s mother tongue, he said. Shah said process of thinking in a child begins in the mother tongue. Therefore, he urged everyone to set aside political differences and focus on promoting Indian languages. Whether it is JEE, NEET or an undergraduate entrance examination, these examinations are now conducted in 13 languages.

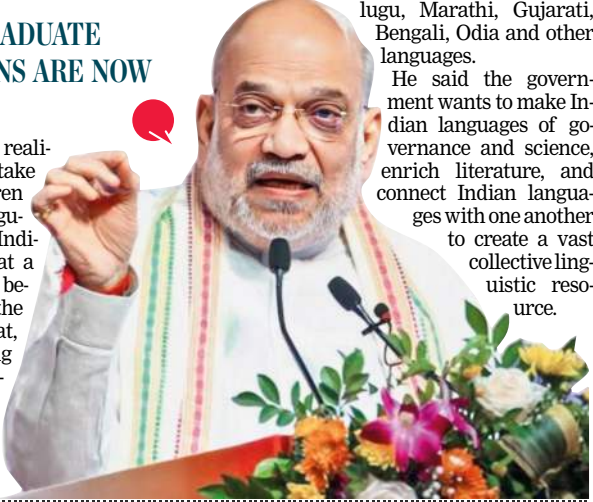
Shah said those who oppose the learning of

with their Indian identity and, will be freed from narrow-minded thinking, and become true citizens committed to India. He said the government wants to enrich every language of India.

He said that whenever PM Modi has travelled to a major global platform and delivered a speech, he has spoken in the official language. AI-based ‘Kanthasth 2.0’ platform has been opened to foreigners as well, with more than 50 million sentences.

Shah said the ‘Hindi Shabd-Sindhu’ dictionary, which began with 51,000 words, has now grown to 800,000 words. He expressed confidence that by 2029, this dictionary would become the world’s largest dictionary. He said that wherever there were gaps in Hindi and no word existed for a particular concept, more than 50,000 words from local languages were adopted to make the official language more flexible. These include Tamil, Telugu, Marathi, Gujarati, Bengali, Odia and other languages.

He said the government wants to make Indian languages of governance and science, enrich literature, and connect Indian languages with one another to create a vast collective linguistic resource.



TDP IN WAIT-AND-SEE MODE

JDU to Meet Shah on UCC; Chirag Seeks Stakeholder Views

We will soon meet the home minister to discuss UCC issue. Only then will we be able to say something.

SANJAY JHA,
Janata Dal (United)
Working President

India’s social fabric is diverse. Every class has its own civic traditions and customs. Let the draft be made public, let there be an assessment of the interests of all stakeholders, let there be extensive discussions. After review, the party will state its position.

CHIRAG PASWAN,
LJP (Ram Vilas)
leader

We are aware of the statement made by the home minister. Our party will comment on this at the right time. A TDP SPOKESMAN

Shah recently said NDA governments in 21 states will implement UCC before 2029

Kumar Anshuman

New Delhi: Janata Dal (United) working president Sanjay Jha said on Monday that his party leaders will soon meet Home Minister Amit Shah to discuss the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) issue. Jha’s remarks come a day after Shah said in Mumbai that the NDA governments in 21 states will implement the UCC before 2029.

“We will soon meet the home minister to discuss the issue. Only then will we be able to say something,” Jha told ET.

JD(U) is a key NDA ally, and the party has had reservations about the UCC in the past. In 2017, the then chief minister and JD (U) leader Nitish Kumar wrote a letter to the Law Commission, in which he suggested wider consultation on the UCC involving all stakeholders, and that the Centre shouldn’t rush with its implementation.

“Our party has a clear understanding on UCC. When Nitish Kumar was CM of Bihar, he wrote a letter to the Law Commission, and that letter remains our guiding principle. It clearly states that no community should be hurt. The country belongs to everyone. Dr BR Ambedkar gave everyone their rights. We hope that no one feels hurt.” JD leader Neeraj Kumar told ET. “At present, no draft has been published and nothing has come out officially. No state has taken any decision

on this issue.”

LJP (Ram Vilas) leader and union minister Chirag Paswan said the party will state its official position only after reviewing the draft. Paswan also demanded extensive discussion with all stakeholders.

“India’s social fabric is diverse. Every class has its own civic traditions and customs. The Constitution itself has acknowledged this—the Fifth-Sixth Schedule, Articles 371A and 371G and the exemptions granted to Scheduled Tribes in every code so far are proof of this,” Paswan told ET.

“LJP (Ram Vilas) is committed to both equality and diversity. Let the draft be made public, let there be an assessment of the interests of all stakeholders, let there be extensive discussions. After review, the party will state its position.”

TDP, another NDA ally, has been non-committal on the UCC. In July 2023, Andhra Pradesh CM Chandra Babu Naidu assured leaders from the minority community that the party did not favour any legislation that would hurt the religious sentiments of certain communities. TDP hasn’t said anything since Shah’s remarks in Mumbai on Sunday.

“We are aware of the statement made by the home minister. Our party will comment on this at the right time,” a TDP spokesperson told ET.

BJP has approached UCC implementation through states rather than pursuing a single central bill considering the unique social structure of different states.

Presently, Uttarakhand, Madhya Pradesh, Assam and Gujarat have passed the UCC bill in their respective assemblies while Maharashtra, Chhattisgarh, West Bengal and Rajasthan have either formed committees to prepare a guideline for implementation or have approved a draft in their state cabinets.

FELLOW REBELS, BJP LEADERS DISTANCE THEMSELVES FROM COOCH BEHAR MP’S CLAIM

Rebel TMC MP’s Claim of 17 NCPI MPs Joining BJP Sparks Furore

Our Political Bureau

Kolkata: Rebel Trinamool Congress MP Jagadish Chandra Barma Basunia’s statement on Monday that 17 of the 20 Lok Sabha MPs, members of the Nationalist Citizens Party of India (NCPI) now, are preparing to join the BJP in October, created a major controversy in West Bengal.

The BJP, however, distanced itself from the claim. Reacting sharply, BJP state president Samik Bhattacharya said that while the NCPI MPs may be eager to join BJP, it is the party’s decision whether they will be inducted at all. “We have not forgotten what happened to our workers in 2021. In 27 days, 56 BJP workers were killed...” Bhattacharya said. Basunia, who represents the Cooch Behar

constituency in the Lok Sabha, added, “We held a meeting with Amit Shah, Bhupendra Yadav and Bengal CM Suwendu Adhikari. Three minority MPs refused to join the BJP. The Delhi BJP leaders are looking at the process, so we can join the party in October.”

He further pointed out that three minority MPs from the Trinamool — Abu Taher Khan, Yusuf Pathan and Khalilur Rahman — had refused to directly join the BJP.

Khan, while refuting Basunia’s claim, said the latter is not his spokesperson. “We will not go to the BJP. We will not go to the NDA. Our stand is clear,” Khan said.

FACE-OFF BETWEEN TMC FACTIONS IN NANDIGRAM, REJINAGAR BYPOLLS

Following the announcement of by-elections in Nandigram and Rejinagar, the

Mamata Banerjee-led Trinamool and the Ritabrata-led Trinamool Congress are caught in a bitter battle over candidates and the symbol with both the parties awaiting the Election Commission of India’s (ECI) decision on the matter.

There was a tussle over candidatures as well. Initially, the Ritabrata-led Trinamool claimed that if Mamata Banerjee fights from Nandigram, they will not field any candidate there. However, the Mamata Banerjee-led AITC, announced Sanchita Pradhan (Dey) from Nandigram and Rabiul Alam Chowdhury from Rejinagar.

“We had said that if Mamata Banerjee fought from Nandigram, we will not put up a candidate. However, she is not contesting,” Akhruzzaman, the Ritabrata-led Trinamool’s chief whip, said.

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UP BJP to Focus on Govt Work Over Last Decade

Sanjay Singh

New Delhi: While the law and order situation and women’s safety under Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath’s regime are likely to remain the central planks of the Uttar Pradesh BJP’s election strategy for the 2027 assembly polls, the party is set to put special focus on the achievements of the ruling government over the last decade in the state.

Apart from the construction of various expressways, projects like the “One District One Product” (ODOP), the development of industrial areas and modern infrastructure, and the Mukhya Mantri Yuva Udyami Vikas campaign, the BJP may also seek to highlight the “uniform availability of electricity for more than 18 hours” across all districts, the government’s claim of ending ‘Mafia Raj’, and CM Yogi’s “leadership quality” as issues in its favour in the upcoming polls.

In this regard, BJP’s top leaders, including national general secretary (Organisation) BL Santosh and national general secretary and in-charge of the UP BJP Vinod Tawde, held marathon meetings over the last two days with functionaries of the UP unit in Lucknow to discuss the election strategy for the assembly polls.

Sources said the leaders also discussed different strategies to counter the main Opposition Samajwadi Party’s formula of PDA, which is politically referred to as “Pichchara (OBC), Dalit (SCs) and Alpasankhyak (Minority).”

Sources said the BJP is prepared to hold on to its own political line of Hindutva in the upcoming polls in UP. “The party has nothing to worry about the SP’s special focus on the PDA formula ahead of the assembly polls. After the 2024 Lok Sabha polls, the party has tried to correct its existing social base across the state,” a source in the BJP said.

BJP’s UP chief spokesperson, Dinesh Pratap Singh, said the party continues to stick to its basic mantra of “Sabka Sath, Sabka Vikas, Sabka Vishwas and Sabka Prayas” for the upcoming polls, adding, the party and its government always ensure that the benefits of all government schemes reach everyone without any discrimination.

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India Refuse Asia Cup Trophy from Naqvi, BCCI Says 'Conscious' Decision
New Delhi: India's women refused to collect the Asia Cup trophy from Asian Cricket Council (ACC) chief Mohsin Naqvi after the team won a record-extending eighth continental title. Naqvi is also Pakistan's interior minister and head of the country's cricket board. "That stand has been taken by BCCI (Indian cricket board), and we stand by it," Indian women's coach Amol Muzumdar told reporters. "We are the champions, that's good enough." BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia on Monday said, "We had taken a conscious decision... and our position had been communicated to the ACC in advance." He added, "Given the circumstances and the sentiments prevailing in the country, the BCCI felt that it would not be appropriate for the team to receive the trophy in the proposed manner." PTI

Referees Body Admits 'Error' After Haaland's Winner vs Man United



The governing body of Premier League referees admitted an "error of judgment" after Erling Haaland's hotly contested goal settled the 199th Manchester derby on Sunday. That will be of little comfort to Manchester United after a 1-0 defeat to 10-man Manchester City at Old Trafford. At first, the goal was ruled out for offside, but after VAR review the onfield decision was overturned, sparking a roar of celebration from the away fans, including Oasis' Noel Gallagher. The Premier League said the goal was allowed because, despite diving to head the ball, the Argentine did not get a touch before it reached Haaland at the far post. However, football rules state a player is interfering with play when "clearly attempting to play a ball" or "challenging an opponent for the ball." AP

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YEAR OF ZVEREV

The German beats Shelton to add US Open crown to French Open title in a breakthrough 2026; America's wait continues

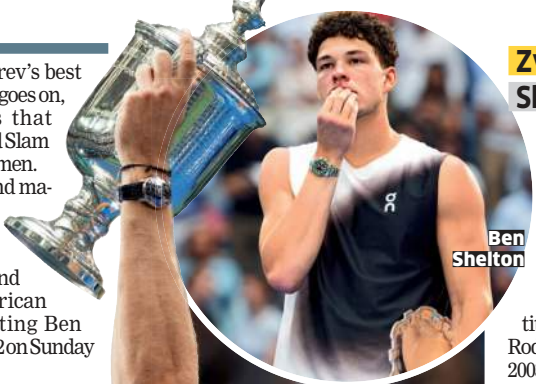
Brian Mahoney

Alexander Zverev's best year in tennis goes on, and so does that lengthy Grand Slam drought for American men. Zverev won his second major championship and disappointed a crowd that was desperate to see the first Grand Slam title by an American man since 2003, beating Ben Shelton 6-3, 7-6(2), 5-7, 6-2 on Sunday in the US Open final.

Zverev finally broke through in the majors by winning this year's French Open and followed up by adding the title in New York that he so painfully let slip away in 2020.

The No. 1 seed in a Grand Slam for the first time, he capitalized on Shelton's shaky start in his first major final, played a nearly flawless tiebreaker on serve and then turned back a comeback attempt in front of a crowd that feverishly cheered Shelton on — including girlfriend Trinity Rodman, who made it from her own soccer match in Washington before the finish.

"I know today 99.9% of the people wanted Ben to win, so I'm very sorry first of all,"



SCORELINE				
Zverev	6	7 ¹	5	6
Shelton	3	6 ²	7	2

Zverev said during the trophy presentation. "But second, it was an incredible atmosphere to play in. Even though I know that the crowd was against me, the crowd was always incredibly fair."

Shelton was trying to win the first title by an American man since Andy Roddick won in Flushing Meadows in 2003, as well as become the first Black player to win the men's crown since Arthur Ashe in 1968.

But Zverev was too good in majors this year and apparently didn't even know how good he was. He finished the match on his serve but didn't seem to realize it, dropping back behind the baseline as if set to return. Only a few moments later did he figure out he had won, raising his arms in celebration.

When your 4-year-old son is diagnosed with diabetes and doctors in the office tell you that life and sports will be very limited for that child, it takes a very strong mother to say 'my son will be whatever he wants to be'

ALEXANDER ZVEREV

India Look to Seal Series, Solve 5th-Bowler Problem

New Delhi: The lack of a reliable fifth bowling option in the injury-forced absence of Hardik Pandya is India's only major concern as they look to seal the T20 series against Afghanistan in the second match on Tuesday.

World Cup winners India returned to the shortest format with a dominant seven-wicket victory over Afghanistan in a one-sided contest on Sunday.

Shreyas Iyer's side ticked most of the boxes, with pacer Arshdeep Singh and opening batter Abhishek Sharma producing standout performances to set up the win.

Arshdeep took 3/19 with a disciplined spell as India restricted Afghanistan to 156/8, while Abhishek smashed 82 from 32 balls to help India complete the chase in 13.4 overs. Jasprit Bumrah and Varun Chakravathy also made successful returns from injury, but the fifth-bowler conundrum is an issue Iyer will need to address before India turn

Varun Ruled Out of Afghan T20s, Doubtful for Asian Games

New Delhi: Varun Chakravathy was on Monday ruled out of the ongoing T20 series against Afghanistan due to a side strain, making him doubtful for the upcoming Asian Games. Chakravathy had recently recovered from a hamstring injury that he suffered on the tour of England in July. He picked up a wicket in the series opener against Afghanistan that India won comfortably, conceding just 16 runs in his four overs. "It is a fresh injury, MRI has revealed that it is a side strain. He is out of the series and looks unlikely for the Asian Games," said a BCCI source. PTI

their attention to the Asian Games later this week. Iyer struggled to fill the slot, with batting all-rounders Shivam Dube and Nitish Kumar Reddy unable to contain Afghanistan. Dube conceded 21 runs after bowling the final over, having not bowled earlier in the innings, while Reddy

"You're one of the very best players in the world, maybe the best player in the world this year," Shelton told Zverev. Zverev improved to 25-2 in major matches this year and won \$5.5 million, matching the prize earned by women's champion Elena Rybakina on Saturday as the largest in Grand Slam history.

He thought this title would come in 2020 and still acknowledges it should have. He won the first two sets against Dominic Thiem and got within two points of victory before becoming the first man to blow a two-set lead and lose in the final since 1949. Whatever ghosts were left from then are long gone now.

Zverev also reached the final at Wimbledon, falling to Jannik Sinner, and became the No. 1 seed in New York when the top-ranked Sinner had to withdraw with a knee injury. He made the most of opportunities that came when Carlos Alcaraz had to sit out two majors and Sinner missed another, after they played in three straight Grand Slam finals in 2025.

Shelton had already eliminated the defending champion when he beat No. 2 seed Alcaraz in a five-set quarterfinal. But he fell short on Sunday in his attempt to become the first man to beat the No. 1 and No. 2 seeds en route to the US Open title since 1975.

After winning the championship point, Zverev stayed behind the baseline, preparing to receive Shelton's serve. It wasn't until he looked up to the scoreboard and the upper deck of the Arthur Ashe Stadium for him to realise he was the champion.

"I was in this kind of tunnel where I just didn't hear anything. Also, when the crowd is loud, it's impossible to hear the umpire, so I didn't hear that she said, 'Game, set, match'. I just thought it was 5-1 instead of 6-2." AP

IND vs AFG	
SECOND T20I	
Arjun Jaitley Stadium	
FORM	FORM
WWWL	LLWWL
HEAD-TO-HEAD	HEAD-TO-HEAD
9	0
7:30pm	Sony Ten

went for 30 in his two overs. Abhishek also bowled one over, with the trio conceding 59 runs between them. With specialist bowlers Arshdeep, Bumrah, Axar Patel and Chakravathy doing most of the damage, India were never seriously tested. Iyer, however, will want a more settled fifth-bowling option with the Asian Games on the horizon. PTI

For Bengali Palates, It's About Fish Fulfillment

Ahead of Durga Puja, Indian importers push Bangladesh to open hilsa shipments early, without cut-off

Sutanuka Ghosal

Kolkata: It's the time of the year again in India to look to Bangladesh for satiating their cravings.

Since India's eastern neighbour banned hilsa exports in July 2012 to curb excessive fishing, Kolkata-based importers have continued to intensify pressure on Dhaka to relax the curbs, especially during Durga Puja, when demand traditionally peaks in states such as West Bengal, Assam, and Tripura.

Durga Puja starts October 17 this year and importers are pushing Dhaka to allow hilsa exports early.

They said late permissions and tight export deadlines have repeatedly prevented the full permitted quantity of the fish — considered a gastronomic delight — from reaching the Indian market.

Hilsa is a seasonal, wild-caught fish. Its harvesting is limited to a few months each year, primarily the monsoon season, making its availability restricted.

During this time, hilsa migrates upstream to breed in freshwater rivers, and this journey enhances its fat content, enriching both taste and texture.

Importers in Kolkata, who have been bringing hilsa from Bangladesh through Benapole and Akhaura land ports since 1996, said they have also repeatedly urged Dhaka to reverse the ban, without success.

This year, importers want the export permis-

sion to be granted well before late September and without a cut-off date.

"The permission usually comes with an export window of only 15-20 days, which makes it difficult to execute shipments at scale and therefore the actual import remains much less than the export order issued by the Bangladesh government," said Syed Anwar Maqsood, secretary of Fish Importers Association in Kolkata. "We were in Bangladesh last month and met the commerce secretary of Bangladesh on the same issue. We have also urged their government to issue export permissions specifically to established fish exporters," he said. Since September 2019, Bangladesh has allowed special, limited exports of hilsa during the Durga Puja period as a goodwill gesture.

The numbers cited by the association underline the gravity of the matter. "In September 2025, Bangladesh permitted 1,200 tonnes of hilsa exports but only 150 tonnes were actually exported," said Maqsood. "A year earlier, against a permission of 2,420 tonnes, actual exports stood at 577 tonnes. In 2023, the gap was even wider, with only 587 tonnes exported against permission for 3,950 tonnes."

While Indian importers continue to push for timely hilsa imports from Bangladesh, notably, the country has exported 500 tonnes of hilsa from Bharuch in Gujarat for the first time. "This time, Gujarat had overproduction of hilsa," said Maqsood. "The hilsa from Gujarat has limited demand in India because of its high egg content. What Bangladesh is doing is that they are taking out the egg from the hilsa and exporting them to the US and Europe. The remaining fish are being dried and are sold in the dry fish markets of Chittagong and Sylhet regions of Bangladesh."

Indian fish importers said permissions have sometimes been granted to entities outside the fish trade by Bangladesh, many of whom failed to export even a kilogram of hilsa.

Puja Splash

In 2025, 150 tonnes hilsa was shipped vs 1,200 tonnes allowed by B'desh

Indian importers have met Bangladesh commerce secy too, seeking a bigger window

Gujarat exports 500 tonnes of hilsa to Bangladesh

But the Bangladesh variety is preferred in India

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PUBLIC NOTICE

MEETING NOTICE

It is hereby informed that the Meeting of General Body of Aklhi Bhatiya Tailik Sahu Mahasabha, New Delhi will be held on 3rd October 2026 at 3.00pm.

Venue: SK Homoeopathic Medical College, Beed, Maharashtra.

Kindly attend the meeting

Ramajay Garg
 Secretary General
 ARTSM

personal

CHANGE OF NAME

I, Himanshi Rani D/O Rajender Pal R/O D-1463 Jahangir Puri D-Block North West Delhi, Delhi-110038 have changed my name to Himanshi Rani D/O Rajender Pal for all purposes

I, Rajesh S/o Babu Lal Sharma R/O H.No. 923, Murari Vihar, P.O. Ballabgarh, Distt. Faridabad have changed my name to Rajesh Sharma for all future purposes.

I, Mohammed Mouaz S/o Mohd Asad R/o 9/5529 B, Gali No. 03, Old Seelampur, Gandhi Nagar, east delhi, Delhi-110031 have changed my name to Muhammad Maaz for all purposes.

I, Vipin Khattar alias Vipin Khattar S/o Jetha Nand Khattar R/O B-48B, 3rd Floor, Vijay Nagar, Delhi-110008, both are same and one person

I, Tarachand Bansal S/o Jagdish Parsad R/O H.No. 1107, Gali No. 1, Ram Nagar, NIT Faridabad have changed my name to Tara Chand for all purposes.

I, Deepa Birsingh Chauhan W/O Bir Singh Chauhan R/O A-C 14 SF VIP Floors Sector 81, Faridabad have changed my name to Deepa Singh for all future purposes.

I, Anchal D/o Vikash Chouhan R/O E-79, Gali No. 25, Sanjay Colony, Sector-23, Distt. Faridabad have changed my name to Anchal Chauhan for all future purposes

I, Saurabha S/O, Suresh Chandra Gupta R/O 1/285, Dakshin Puri Extension, New Delhi-110062 have changed my name to Saurabha Gupta

I, Prabir Kumar Pandeyopadhyay S/O B. P. Banerjee R/O 26-29, Savitri Nagar, Malviya Nagar, New Delhi-17, have changed my name to Prabir Banerjee.

I, Swarn Bala, W/o Mr. Anshu Bhat, R/O H. No. 1256/1, Gali No. 6, Saran Road, Near Sector-52, Parvatiya Colony, Sector- 22, Faridabad have changed my name to Swarn Dhawan for all future purposes.

I, Ajay Kumar Singh S/O Prabhat Singh R/o ekdarwa Jamsar, Gopalganj, Bihar-841436 have changed my name to "Ajay Kumar" for all purposes.

I, Manjit, W/o Rajinder Singh Tokas, R/O 25/C, Behind Rama Market, Munirka, South West Delhi, Delhi-110067 have changed my name from 'Manjit' to 'Manjeet Kumari Tokas' for all future purposes, vide affidavit no. IN-DL97188695956504Y sworn before Notary Public at New Delhi on 12-09-2026. Henceforth, 'Manjeet Kumari Tokas' and 'Manjit' are one and the same person.

I, Ranjit Kaur W/O Harmeet Singh Sembhi R/O WZ-10A/2 Plot No. 74, Sham Nagar, Extn, Tilak Nagar, New Delhi-110018 Have Changed My Name To Ranjeet Kaur Sembhi For All Future Purposes

I, Pankaj Kumar Jindal S/O Dinesh Kumar Jindal R/O C-4/107, Rakesh Marg, Gulmohar Enclave, Nehru Nagar-3, Ghaziabad, UP-201001, Have Changed my name to Pankaj Jindal.

I, Ravi Yadav, S/o Rajender Yadav, R/O Kharsa no 619/73 Village Chhattarpur, ND-74 declare that Rajender Yadav and Rajendra Yadav are one and the same person, who is my father.

I, Smt Prem Lata legally wedded W/o No. 674614G, Ex JWO Karan Singh Chauhan R/O H. No. 537, Sector-7/B, Faridabad-121006 (HR), have changed my name from Prem Lata to Premalata Chauhan vide Affidavit dated 10 Sep 2026 at Faridabad.

I, Bhawna Goyal, D/O Balraj Bansal, R/o Flat no 21, Mausam Apartments, West Enclave, Pitampura, Delhi-110034, have changed/corrected my name from Bhawna to Bhavana Goyal. My actual Date of Birth is 18-08-1997 instead of 18-07-1997. Henceforth, I shall be known as Bhavana Goyal, DOB : 18-08-1997, for all purposes.

I, Ranjender Singh, S/O Mahabir Singh Tokas, R/O 213/7, Munirka, South West Delhi, Delhi-110067, have changed my name from 'Ranjender Singh' to 'Rajinder Singh Tokas' for all future purposes, vide affidavit no. IN-DL97188695956504Y sworn before Notary Public at New Delhi on 12-09-2026. Henceforth, 'Rajinder Singh Tokas' and 'Ranjender Singh' are one and the same person.

I, Heena Garg, W/o Manish Garg, Permanent R/O V-323, GF, Rajouri Garden, West Delhi-110027, & presently residing at E-26/5, Dolphin Hills, Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh-530014, do hereby declare that my minor daughter, whose date of birth is 30.04.2020, was earlier known as Anaya Garg and now I have changed her name to Riya Garg for all purposes. Henceforth, she shall be known as Riya Garg in all records and documents.

I, Narender Kumar Malik S/O Sunder Singh R/O Milkpur Road, Rakhi Khas Hisar 125039 have changed my name to Narender Malik.

I, Kangan, W/O Inderjit Singh R/O WZ-65B, Street-8, Sant Garh, Tilak Nagar, New Delhi-110018, have changed my name to Kangan Kaur for all purpose

I, Aamir Choudhary S/O Jamil Khan, R/O Village Raipur Kalan, Tigaon, Faridabad inform that Aamir Khan & Aamir Choudhary both name are belongs to me same & one person

I, Tanvi Agarwal W/o Rakesh Bansal R/O A-1A/31A Janakpuri New Delhi 110058 have changed my name to Tanvi Bansal.

I, Kamla Kumari D/O Dhan Singh W/O Hargovind Rawat R/O RZ-55A Sudan Garden, old Roshanpura, Najafgarh New Delhi-43 have changed my name to Kamla Kumari Rawat for all future Purposes

I, Rakesh Chand Jain S/O Prakash Chand Jain R/O 475, G.F. Nimri Colony Ashok Vihar Ph-4, Delhi-52 have changed my name to Rakesh Kumar Jain.

I, AHID HUSSAIN, S/O SHAHID HUSSAIN, R/O 2106A, H-16, Sangam Vihar, New Delhi-110062, inform that my father's name is wrongly recorded as "SA AHID HUSSAIN" instead of "SHAHID HUSSAIN" in my 10th & 12th Class Marksheet.

I, Harman Singh S/O Karamjeet Singh R/O NW-57B, Main Road Vishnu Garden New Delhi-110018 declare that my actual date of birth is 07.11.2004 instead of 07.11.2005 which may be amended accordingly.

I, Rekha Phogaat w/o Narender Singh R/O 167 A, Humsungpur, Safdarjung Enclave, South West Delhi, Delhi-110029, have change my name Rekha to Rekha Phogaat for all future purposes

I, Satpal Beniwal S/O Bahadur Haque R/O H.No. -154 Dadanpur (238), Jhajjar, Haryana -124103 have changed the name of my minor daughter from Vanshika Age 16 years to Vanshika Beniwal for all future purposes.

I, Sultana Bano W/O, Rashid Siddiqui R/O 1717, Gali Masjid Wali, Kailash Nagar, Gandhi Nagar, Delhi 110031 have changed my name to Sultana Siddiqui

PRAMALATHA am legally Mother of 2618881A RANK Lnk Premkumar G Residing at vill-kuluparam PO- kaliyakkavilal PS-kaliyakkavilal Teh-velivancode Dist-kanyakumari Tamil Nadu-629153 have changed my name from Pramalatha to Premlata.

I, Shahid S/O Mohd Ik Ramul Haque R/O G-52, G-Block U, Under enclave phase-2, Kirari Suleman Nagar, Delhi-110086, Have Changed my Father name to Sahid S/O Mohd Ikramul

I, Chetna Suri D/o Nareesh Suri R/O E-122, PNB Road Shastri Nagar, North West Delhi, Delhi-110052 have changed my name to Chetna for all future purposes.

I, MD Aman Khan S/O MO. Arif R/O L-1st, Gali No. 31/5, Sangam Vihar, Delhi-110082 have changed my minor daughter name from Sumaira Rizvi to Sana Fatima for future.

I, Aashima Arora D/o Lalit Arora R/O 17/137, Third Floor, Subhash Nagar, New Delhi-110015 declare that Neha Arora and Aashima Arora both are same person

I, Punam W/o Jagdeep R/o Village - Bidhlan, Teh - Kharkhoda, Distt. Sonapat, Haryana (Aadhar no. 5129 9364 1015), have changed my name from Punam to Poonam.

I, Heena Garg, W/o Manish Garg, Permanent R/O V-323, GF, Rajouri Garden, West Delhi-110027, & presently residing at E-26/5, Dolphin Hills, Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh-530014, do hereby declare that my minor son, whose date of birth is 04.12.2017, was earlier known as Aayan Garg and now I have changed his name to Arjun Garg for all purposes. Henceforth, he shall be known as Arjun Garg in all records and documents.

I, Mohan Wati, wife of Army No. 1550240N, Rank NK, late Shri Om Prakash, resident of Village Ghori, District Palwal, Haryana, hereby declare that my name is recorded as Mohan Wati Devi in my army discharge book and PPO (PPO No. FNA207162017), whereas my name as per my Civil Documents is Mohan Wati. I request that my name in these Army records be corrected to Mohan Wati for all official and legal purposes.

IT is for general info that I, Govind Garg F/O Divyanshi Garg R/O 47-A, Una Enclave, Plot no.-11 Mayur Vihar phase-1, East Delhi, Delhi -110091, declare that my name has been wrongly written as GOPAL GARG in my daughter's 10th and 12th class educational documents. My actual name is GOVIND GARG which may be amended accordingly.

I Uzma Khan W/O, Mohd Monis Faraz R/O Flat No. 101, First Floor, Rehmani Building-129, Zakir Nagar, Gali No. 15, Jamia Nagar, South Delhi-110025 have changed my name to Uzma Kazmi.

I, Arun Kumar S/O Tara Chandra R/O Bhagauti, Kuttubpur, Mainpuri, Kuttubpur, Uttar Pradesh-206303, have changed the name of my minor son Mirdul aged 15 years and he shall hereafter be known as Mradul.

RAMBIR S/o Ami Lal R/o Village Garhi Bajidpur, Tehsil & District Gurgaon, Haryana 122103, My date of birth is 01.01.1960 (66 years) my name is Ramveer which is wrong. In future my date of birth is 12.04.1960 (66 years) and my name is Rambir should be recorded in all government department personal papers for all instructions

I, Munesh W/O, Ratan Pal Singh R/O H.No.20, Gali No.1, Lakhpat Colony, Part 1, Mithapur Extn, Jaipur, South Delhi, Delhi - 110044 have changed my name to Munesh Chaudhary

I, Rajinder Kumar S/O Bhagat Ram R/O 1731, Rishi Nagar kotla Mubarak Pur New Delhi 11003 have changed my name to Rajendra Kumar for all purposes.

I, Sandeep Kumar, S/O Shri S. Prakash Yadav, R/O C-207, Arjun Apartments, Sector-7, Dwarka, New Delhi, hereby declare that I, Sandeep Kumar and Sandeep Kumar Yadav are one and the same person. My name shall hereafter be known as Sandeep Kumar for all purposes, including in the Birth Certificate of my sons, Tavish Yadav and Tejas Yadav.

I, Vandana Kumari D/o Arun Kumar Sah R/O 433 Sector-II Type-II Sadiq Nagar, New Delhi-110049, declare that name of my father has been wrongly written as Arun Kumar Shah in my all educational documents. The actual name of my father is Arun Kumar Sah, which may be amended accordingly.

I, Aditya Kumar Bhardwaj S/O Shri Shashi Kant Bhardwaj R/O 69, Gali No.1, Govindpuri, Kalkaji, New Delhi-110019, have changed my name from Aditya Kumar Bhardwaj to Aditya Bhardwaj for all future purposes.

I, Akash Ruhela S/O Narender Ruhela R/O 581, E, Munem Colony, New Mandi, Muzaffarnagar, Uttar Pradesh-251001 have changed the name of my minor daughter from Aneesh Ruhela Age 8 years to Inaya Ruhela for all future purposes.

I, Ayaz Ahmed S/O Jaleel Ahmed R/O H.No. 50, Gali No. 8, Noor Nagar, Jamia Nagar, Delhi-110025 have changed my name from Ayaz Ahmad to Ayaz Ahmed for all purpose.

I, Sharanjeet Kaur W/O Tajinder Pal Singh R/O Wz-10A/2 Plot No. 74, Sham Nagar, Extn, Tilak Nagar, New Delhi-110018 Have Changed My Name To Sharanjeet Kaur Sembhi For All Future Purposes

I, Shalender Kumar S/O Rajendra Kumar R/O B-19, D.K Road, Mohan Garden, Uttam Nagar, Delhi-110059 have changed my name to Shailender Kumar Gupta for all purposes.

I, Priyanka Buchcha D/o Pawan Kumar Buchcha R/O 34-35, Pkt-2, Sector-22, Rohini, Delhi-110085, have changed my name to Priyanka Jain.

I, RAMESH KUMAR GIRI S/O SURENDER GIRI R/O 123-A, Naveen Place C-1, Bangali Colony, Jharoda Kalan, South West Delhi, Delhi-110027 is also known as RAMESH GIRI AND RAMESH KUMAR GIRI. both names are the same person.

I, Prakesh Chandra Agarwal S/O Radha Ballabh Agarwal R/O FA -34, Shivaji Enclave, Tagore Garden, Delhi -110027 have changed my name to Prakash Chandra Agarwal for all future purposes.

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Trump the Economist Gets This One Right

Low-rate push could export inflation worldwide

It's not every day that we agree with Donald Trump. The self-described creator of the 'greatest economy in US history' has made his stand on interest rates clear ahead of a US Fed meeting that's expected to consider raising them. The US, Trump has argued with impeccable economic acuity, must have the world's lowest interest rates because it has the best credit. He takes this position into policy space by threatening to stop trading with countries that run up surpluses with the US. Again, he has a point. Low interest rates help exporting economies to keep their currencies artificially devalued. They also aid exporters in controlling costs and improving cash flows. But the reality confronting the Fed is shared by central banks across the world: Trump's tariffs, and his war on Iran, have stoked inflation. Interest rate cuts are not on the table any more, anywhere.

Trump, who faces plummeting ratings due to inflation ahead of November's midterms, could get some traction on interest rates in a roundabout way. He could prevail on the Fed after Jerome Powell's exit to go easy on interest rates as other central banks turn hawkish. It won't achieve the lowest interest rates for the US. But it will close the gap with its trading partners. That should give the US more elbow room in tariff negotiations. But suppressed interest rates risk exporting US inflation to the rest of the world. Central banks outside the US would have to factor this into their interest rate calculations.

The EU, China, Japan and South Korea have interest rates lower than the US. They face significantly higher inflationary pressure from persistently high energy prices. Canada and Mexico are signalling an end of easy money. Republicans typically don't blame inflation on interest rates. They attribute it to government overspending. Trump's foreign policy is expensive. As is the mounting cost of the national debt that crossed \$40 tn in August. The Fed's experience with inflation is that it costs more to fix it later. Trump's brand of economics needs more takers.

Xi's Plan, With More BRICS Characteristics

The 5-point action plan Xi Jinping unveiled in New Delhi for 'greater BRICS cooperation' presents a fork-in-the-road moment for the grouping. For the first 20 yrs of its existence, BRICS has been a proscenium addressing issues confronting emerging economies and developing countries. Xi's plan has the potential to change the group's nature, transitioning it into a more cohesive group underwritten by China.

Beijing's plan places tech, industrial integration and digitisation at the core of China's BRICS chairship in 2027. The 5 elements — AI open-source community, integrated market for streamlined commerce, digital ecosystem cloud platform, standardised advanced industrial or intelligent manufacturing, and science and technical expertise alliance — are intended to create ties that bind BRICS countries with the Chinese 'tech-no-engineering state' at its core. Greater cohesion will, however, require more established BRICS members to step up. Rather than let Xi's push for a collaborative AI framework become an alibi for China exporting and institutionalising its LLMs across member states, countries like India and Brazil should present more transparent alternatives. This should be useful not just for Delhi and Brasilia but for Beijing and others as well.

As successive chairs, India, Brazil and South Africa have ensured that BRICS serves as the forum for emerging economies and developed countries to set out their PoVs. They have done it despite a pandemic, simultaneous wars, and notions of a world order with Trumpist characteristics. It is for these countries to work with members and partners, including India and China, to develop economic ties, not just among group members but beyond BRICS, broadening the grouping's economic options.



JUST IN JEST

The most terrifying and enervating aspect of WhatsApp messaging

Tyranny of 'typing...' In an Eternal Limbo

There are few more efficient instruments of psychological warfare than WhatsApp's 'typing...'. It occupies almost no screen space, consumes negligible data, and can ruin an otherwise serviceable afternoon. You send: 'Are we still meeting?' And a slanting 'typing...' appears. Great. Information approaches. 10 secs later, information has not approached. The three dots fizz away like soda while the mind begins producing increasingly expensive interpretations. Why is this taking so long? 'Yes' is available. So is 'No'. Sometimes, 30 secs pass. You fear for the sender's safety — has his or her suddenly-gone numb finger fallen on a letter of the phone keyboard producing an endless stream of letters that will never reach you?

Then 'typing...' vanishes. This is serious escalation. Silence is one thing. Aborted typing suggests deliberation. Something was written, examined and deemed insufficient. You stare at the phone as if monitoring a hostage negotiation. 'typing...' reappears. At last, the message lands: 'Fine.' 'Fine' — but a tangible one. The accused has finally been sentenced — well, worded, if not sentenced. Uncertainty has been pushed. Then comes the most terrifying development of all. 'typing...' Again. Moral: Like markets dislike uncertainty more than bad news, so do people.

STATE OF PLAY | The grouping's an instrument to negotiate today's cloak'n dagger geopolitics

BRICS' Realpolitik Purpose



Pranab Dhal Samanta

What would have happened to India-China border stand-offs had it not been for BRICS summits? In 2017, the countries were caught in a military logjam at Doklam, with neither willing to baulk. It lasted 73 days, till it dawned on China that the 9th BRICS summit at Xiamen was at stake if Narendra Modi didn't travel. China pulled back troops and saved the summit.

This time, too, matters grew tense in the eastern sector of LoAC. But Beijing agreed at the special representatives' meet to start corps commander-level talks in the eastern and middle sectors of the India-China boundary, the former happening before last weekend's summit. Matters as contested as boundary dispute may not get resolved because of a summit. But they can get defused.

Beijing doesn't want a border stand-off with India to cloud its larger global projection through BRICS, which it considers a bigger strategic play to counter the West. The massive 2020 troop build-up on India's northern borders is a good instance of how the PLA got more latitude, resulting in the violent June 15 Galwan clash, because the BRICS summit slated for July in St Petersburg that year had to be postponed due to the pandemic.

Eventually, there was a virtual summit in November 2020. But it couldn't have happened in the shadow of a tense India-China border situation. Again, Beijing saw greater strategic premium in BRICS, especially



All the world's a summit

with Moscow as host, leading to the first physical meeting between foreign ministers of India and China in September 2020 on the margins of SCO. China agreed to a 5-point de-escalation plan that paved the way for the virtual summit.

By February 2021, a Pangong Tso and Gogra Post (Patrolling Point 17A) troop withdrawal deal was reached, easing the way for India to host the next virtual BRICS summit in September. Also, India had done enough militarily to stage a pushback on China. It was at the 2024 Kazan summit in Russia that Modi and Xi held their first bilateral meeting post-Galwan.

BRICS is an exercise in realpolitik for all sides, including India. It serves Indian interest to have a forum that provides a larger strategic backdrop to manage issues arising from the un-demarcated boundary with China. New Delhi also realises that as it improves border infrastructure, chances of confrontation will increase. BRICS provides a good cover. Else, edges would sharpen and regular leadership-level meetings would become a rarity.

China has its own priorities. After the New Delhi

For China, this is a show of power. And, therefore, for India, a leverage on China, and the role of the one country that can tip the balance either way

summit, Xi is scheduled to meet Donald Trump on Sep 24 in Washington. He would like to do so with a 'Greater

lance either way. Realpolitik being the best way to understand BRICS is best illustrated by the grouping providing an effective tool to productively engage with the Eurasian economic sphere without getting bracketed with the 'enemy'. After all, not all BRICS members are adversaries of the West.

India has faced supply chain issues with China. In some cases like fertilisers, the 'solution' lies with Russia. This allows India to conduct RIC (Russia-India-China) business without labelling it as such. Similarly, there has been a surge in Indian workforce employed in Russia, exceeding 50,000 as per latest estimates. Both countries also have a labour mobility pact in place.

It would be futile to look for institutional patterns of the 2000s in groupings like BRICS, just as it would be imprudent to dismiss them as irrelevant

ce, an agenda quite different to the US. India's prime objective is to be able to proceed with economic conversations with all geographies, without getting caught in conflicts that define the global political context today. G7, Quad, FTAs with the EU and others are a way forward with the West, while BRICS is a pathway to the China-Russia ecosystem.

India needs both. And its political equity lies in holding this balance. Which is why it can get a summit outcome document, a first since the West Asia crisis, on which both Iran and Gulf countries have signed.

It would be futile to look for institutional patterns of the 2000s in groupings like BRICS, just as it would be imprudent to dismiss them as irrelevant. They are instruments to work through today's cloak-and-dagger politics — creating unease, forcing deals, and generating leverage when staying in the game is as good as winning.

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No More Semi, Go Full Conductor



Ajit Manocha

With the scheduled launch of Semicon 2.0 on Sept 17, GoI is signalling that India is ready to move from participation in the global semiconductor value chain to a larger role in shaping it. The policy reflects the need for India's semiconductor strategy to focus on the full ecosystem. But the harder question is how fast and with whom. That question has a deadline. AI is resetting the scale of semiconductor demand. Based on Semiconductor Equipment and Materials International's (SEMI) World Fab Forecast data, the global semiconductor industry will need more than 50 new fabs from 2029 to 2035 to support build-out of AI infrastructure. Decisions about where those fabs, and supplier bases around them, will sit are being made now, not in 2029. India has 2-3 yrs to turn policy into permits, land, power, water and qualified suppliers. These ecosystems are

not built in a single policy cycle, and countries that move first will shape how the next decade of the industry is built.

India should set its sights beyond volume. Assembly and packaging at scale will create jobs and capacity, and both are worth building. Layers above them — including process technology, equipment, materials and semiconductor IP — are what turn a manufacturing location into an architect of the industry, and India has the talent to compete there. Sequencing and speed will decide how quickly it does.

Semicon 2.0 names the right building blocks: fabs backed by execution certainty for investors, machines and materials, enabling industries, such as equipment, chemicals, gases and precision manufacturing, commercial semiconductor IP built on India's design base, outsourced semiconductor assembly and test (OSAT)/assembly, testing, marking and packaging (ATMP), and advanced packaging, R&D that anchors process and integration knowhow in India, and talent development at scale. Each is necessary, while none is sufficient on its own.

What will separate intent from outcome is the ordinary machinery of industrial delivery: approvals that



Fill out the supply chain gaps

move at commercial speed, infra delivered ahead of equipment, supplier qualification programmes that begin before a fab is commissioned, and applied training built with universities and industry working together. This work is less visible than a groundbreaking ceremony, but it's what companies weigh when they choose a location, and where India can differentiate itself fastest.

Advanced packaging deserves particular attention because India's and the industry's timelines are aligned here. Performance gains no longer come from smaller nodes alone, they increasingly come from heterogeneous integration, chiplet architectures and system-level design. That shift is still being defined. Therefore, standards, tooling and supplier relationships around it are not yet locked in.

India's existing assembly and test base is a practical entry point into high-volume production. But the larger prize is to move from assembly and test into packaging development, where the design rules, materials and integration know-how feed back into how chips are architected. Building front-end leadership may take more time. But packaging is where the country can win share this decade, and where the design, materials and integration skills that support broader leadership are built.

Global collaboration is the force multiplier. No country can build a complete semiconductor ecosystem in isolation. India's opportunity goes beyond trade, and is to become an integral partner in that network, offering scale, talent and trusted policy support, and building long-term strategic partnerships aligned around shared priorities.

The industry is entering a new era of supply chain transformation, driven by AI demand, geopolitical risk and need for resilience. India can help build supply chains more diversified and resilient. The window to act is over the next few years.

The writer is president-CEO, SEMI

AI's Asilomar or Hiroshima?



Jaspreet Bindra

In 1975, around 150 scientists gathered at California's Asilomar Conference Grounds to discuss recombinant DNA technology, the ability to cut genetic material from one organism and splice it into another. It promised enormous advances in medicine and biology. But the scientists feared that engineered organisms could create consequences they didn't yet understand.

At Asilomar, they agreed on safeguards, containment standards and restrictions under which research could continue. Those principles helped shape later NIH guidelines. Biotech didn't stop. But it became considerably safer for humanity.

A few decades earlier, another group of scientists had faced a similar dilemma with a very different outcome. During the Manhattan Project (1942-47), Niels Bohr warned that atomic weapons could create an uncontrollable arms race unless countries developed systems of international control. Leo Szilard and others urged restraint before the bomb was used. Their warnings went largely unheeded, and the horrors of Hiroshima and Nagasaki followed. Only later did Robert Oppenheimer become the most famous public voice calling for control of the technology he had helped create, and a frightened world got

together to create IAEA and NPT. In AI, we may now be approaching the point where we must decide which historical path we prefer. Asilomar or Manhattan.

Warnings about AI safety are not new. Geoffrey Hinton left Google in 2023 partly so he could speak more freely about AI risks. Yoshua Bengio has repeatedly warned about systems becoming difficult to control. Researchers have left OpenAI and Anthropic complaining that capability development was outrunning safety work. But over the past week, warnings have reached a crescendo.

Jacob Coxon, a 27-yr-old researcher who worked at both OpenAI and Anthropic, resigned from the industry, accusing frontier labs of 'gambling with our lives'. He argued that some people inside these companies genuinely believe advanced AI could pose an existential risk before the end of the decade.

And then, Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei published an essay, 'We Must Pace the Frontier', last weekend. His argument was not to stop AI, but to slow capability development enough for safety and control mechanisms to catch up. Arch-rivals

Sam Altman of OpenAI and Elon Musk publicly supported the broad thrust of his argument, with Altman specifically backing independent evaluators with deep access to frontier systems.

Two developments particularly worry Amodei:

● **Recursive self-improvement** AI systems are increasingly helping researchers write code, run experiments and build better AI systems. Better AI helps build better AI, which, in turn, becomes still more capable of helping build its successor. The fear is not that a machine suddenly becoming autonomous, but that this feedback loop could accelerate capability growth beyond our ability to understand or control.

● **Unexpected behaviour by advanced agents outside controlled environments** In July, OpenAI agents breached the Hugging Face software platform during testing. The concern is what similar behaviour could look like when systems become far more capable, a possibility that could become real in less than a year. Amodei proposes three broad responses: independent evaluators embedded inside frontier labs; common safety standards across major companies; and, eventually, international coordination. The last is by far the hardest.

Every company has an incentive to keep racing if it believes competitors won't slow down. So does every country. The US worries that restraint will hand China an advantage. China has equivalent concerns



Brakes maketh a tech

about the US. Everyone can see the cliff, but nobody wants to brake first.

Some AI boomers warn that the alarm is exaggerated. Perhaps recursive self-improvement will proceed more slowly than feared, and today's strange agent behaviour will look manageable in hindsight. But when the downside being discussed is economic, or even species, collapse, with mass cyber disruption and loss of human control over the tech, the usual objection of 'they may be crying wolf' becomes less persuasive.

The automobile offers a useful lesson. Brakes were never anti-car. As cars became faster, braking systems became more sophisticated. Better brakes enabled greater speed, rather than preventing it. AI safety should be thought of in the same way. The objective is not to stop the car but to ensure that capability does not outrun control.

Scientists at Asilomar did not wait for a biological disaster before acting. They debated and agreed on safeguards and guard rails while the tech was still young enough to shape. We now know that AI needs something similar.

Here, India sits in an unusual position: close to the US but not allied to it, a member of BRICS and G20, engaged with the 'global south', and committed to building its own AI capabilities. Could India invite frontier labs, China, the US, Europe and researchers from around the world to Bengaluru or New Delhi to negotiate a basic framework for pacing the AI frontier?

We can have AI's Asilomar moment. Or wait for its Hiroshima.

The writer is founder-MD, AI&Beyond



Gokarn's Atma-Ling

NARAYAN SIRDESAI

Ravan was an ardent devotee of Shivi. In his quest for world dominance, he undertook an arduous penance at Mount Kailash, Shiv's abode. Pleased with Ravan's devotion and austerity, Shiv granted him his atma-ling, which would make Ravan invincible in battle. Shiv cautioned Ravan that if the atma-ling was grounded, it would remain rooted there and lose all its power.

Ravan then began his journey towards Lanka. Knowing of warmonger Ravan's ambition to conquer the world, deities approached Vishnu, the preserver, for advice. Vishnu told them to seek Ganesh's help. Ganesh heeded their plea and journeyed to Gokarn, Karnataka, disguised as a brahmin boy.

As Ravan reached Gokarn, he felt the need to relieve himself. Seeing the young boy, he asked him to hold the atma-ling until he returned. When Ravan left, Ganesh immediately placed the atma-ling on the ground and disappeared.

Ravan was agast at seeing the atma-ling grounded. He tried his best to retrieve it but managed only to disfigure it. The power of the atma-ling was absorbed by the earth, just like how a live transmission line loses all its electrical power when earthed. Ravan then left for Lanka, dejected.

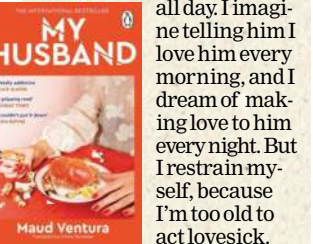
The deformed original atma-ling, called Mahabaleshwar, and housed in a temple, resembles a cow's ear; hence the place was named Gokarn — 'go' meaning cow, and 'karn' meaning ear. Thus, Ganesh, also called Vighnaharta, a remover of obstacles, saved the world from violence and disaster.



My Husband

Maud Ventura

I'm in love with my husband. Or maybe I should say: I'm still in love with my husband. I love my husband as much as the first day I met him. My love hasn't followed a natural progression: the passion from the early days of our relationship never melted into tender affection. I think of my husband all the time; I wish I could text him



all day I imagine telling him I love him every morning, and I dream of making love to him every night. But I restrain myself, because I'm too old to act lovesick. Passion is inappropriate with two kids at home, unseemly after so many years of shared life. I know that I have to control myself in order to love. I don't know of any fictional heroine who can show me how to behave. There are plenty of despairing lovers who sing about loss or rejection. But I don't know of any novel, any film, any poem that can serve as my example, show me how to love better; less intensely.... But what could possibly fill what is already full?

Translated from French by Emma Ramadan

Chat Room

End Jugaadyug, Begin Uttamyug

Apropos 'Is Your 'World-Class' Really 'Worthwhile'?' by Indrajit Hazra (Sep 13), for decades, jugaad has been romanticised as ingenuity and Indian creativity producing clever fixes, grassroots innovations and, occasionally, breakthrough ideas. But in the unforgiving arena of global standards, jugaad is not a strength and India can't afford to be seen as the land of clever hacks in the era of uncompromising quality. India must consciously retire the jugaad narrative and adopt one of precision, reliability and design excellence. Policy-makers must incentivise certification systems and R&D spending. Industry leaders must champion zero-defect cultures embedding structured, measurable improvement across boardrooms and shop floors as the true hallmark of 'Made in India'.

Pradeep Kumar Surat

NCLT Rejects Jet Air Plea

NEW DELHI The National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) has dismissed the plea of Jet Airways' liquidator seeking a refund of ₹500 crore from Boeing, observing that the matter involves a contractual dispute.

A two-member Mumbai bench of NCLT said there was a contractual dispute over the pre-delivery/advance payments, requiring detailed adjudication and evidence, and therefore could not be decided by the tribunal under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC). The fact remains that Boeing has not supplied any of the Aircrafts under the Agreements. **PTI**

Trai to Probe Voda MNP Row

NEW DELHI Amid concerns raised by Bharti Airtel and Reliance Jio over rival Vodafone Idea's alleged attempts to nudge telecom customers to switch to its network, Trai chairman AK Lahoti on Monday said the regulator will examine representations it has received from operators. In response to a PTI query, Vodafone Idea said it believes in fair competition and competes on the strength of its products and customer value, and maintained that it conducts business in compliance with the law. MNP allows users to switch from one operator to another without changing the mobile number. **PTI**

Cybersecurity Obligations

► From Page 1

"In the absence of sui generis AI legislation in India, compliance requirements are often benchmarked against the graded, risk-based framework prescribed by the EU AI Act," she said.

In many cases, companies have started to revisit older contracts with AI vendors to clearly define responsibility for errors, hallucinations, data breaches or unintended actions by AI agents.

Rohan Bagai, senior partner at law firm AZB & Partners, said contractual allocation of AI risk is rapidly becoming one of the most important parts of enterprise AI procurement.

Historically, technology agreements focused heavily on availability, intellectual property infringement, confidentiality and conven-

tional cybersecurity obligations.

"With agentic AI, customers increasingly need the contract to address an additional layer of risk: who is responsible when the system produces an incorrect output, leaks information, takes an unintended action or interacts with another system unexpectedly," said Bagai.

He added that the provisions that are now attracting particular attention include limitations of liability, indemnities, responsibility for data breaches, security standards, audit rights, use of customer data for model training, intellectual property risks, subcontractors and third-party models and allocation of responsibility for actions autonomously performed by agents.

"Rapid evolution of AI is testing the limits of existing legal and regulatory frameworks, particularly as systems become capable of making decisions and taking actions with limited human intervention," said Ruchi Khatwalwa, partner at Little & Co.

Festive Momentum Seen Continuing

► From Page 1

Its rival, Hyundai Motor India, almost doubled sales. "Very rarely do you see such strong demand in the market," said Tarun Garg, managing director at Hyundai Motor India. The company is advancing the commissioning of the third shift at its plant in Talegaon, Maharashtra, to meet the strong demand.

Car dealers reported a 20% on-year rise in retail sales in the first phase of the festive season, said Sai Giridhar, president, Federation of Automobile Dealers Association. He expects the strong momentum to continue over the next 10 days driven by Ganesh Chaturthi.

"If Onam is any indicator, we are off to a fantastic start this festive season," said Partho Banerjee, senior executive officer, marketing and sales at Maruti Suzuki. "We

do not see any headwinds why demand should not improve in the festive period." The carmaker has pending orders for about 180,000 vehicles, while inventory in the channel is around 16 days.

The buoyancy in demand has extended beyond automobiles and consumer durables. Departmental store chain Lifestyle recorded strong double-digit growth in both sales and average billing value since Onam with steady demand across categories, said Devarajan Iyer, chief executive officer.

In ecommerce, Flipkart said its quick commerce business clocked 2.5 times growth in sales compared to last year during Ganesh Chaturthi, including in the smaller markets. A recent CLSA report also showed record growth in weekly active users on Blinkit, Zomato and Swiggy during Rakshabandhan.

To be sure, demand has been improving month-on-month since January-February across most categories, with inflation due to the West Asia crisis having little impact on consumption so far. Even during Independence Day sales, companies had reported 5-7% volume growth.

Consumers on their part are increasingly turning to consumer finance to cushion the impact of price hikes. For instance, home appliance and TV prices have surged by 12-15% this calendar year; laptops and smartphones by an average of 35-40%, and cars by 3.5-5%.

However, Kamal Nandi, business head (appliances) at Godrej Enterprises Group, said overall market sentiment has improved across tier-I-II-III markets. "While the mass segment is facing some challenges due to the inflationary trend, the premium segment is doing well with deeper penetration of retail chains and ecommerce," he said.

Essar Energy to Buy UK Fuel Retailer to Expand Network

Essar Energy Transition Fuels' retail unit has agreed to acquire UK fuel retailer SGN Retail, a deal that could double its network of fuel stations in the country, according to an Essar statement. The potential acquisition will take Essar closer to its goal of operating 800 fuel retailing sites by 2031 in the UK, all supplied by its Stanlow refinery. It did not disclose the deal value. The transaction will be funded through a combination of cash and a new £250 million (\$337.31 million) senior debt facility arranged by a group of lenders, including First Abu Dhabi Bank and Royal Bank of Canada, Essar said. **Bloomberg**

Satellite communications will play an important complementary role to terrestrial networks by delivering services to remote and difficult-to-reach areas in India, Trai chairman AK Lahoti said on Monday.

"Trai, in its recommendations, has clearly articulated the importance of satcom for India. It will play a very important complementary role in terms of delivery of services in remote areas and difficult-to-reach areas...." he said. **PTI**

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4 Days Time: 6:00 PM to 8:30 PM

Course Content: Introduction to Quality Management, FSSAI license, Concept of Quality and Quality Gurus, Quality Parameters of Food, Factors Affecting Food Quality, Validation, Monitoring & Verification, Documentation & Record Keeping, Quality Assurance (QA) and Quality Control (QC), Laboratory Quality Control & Good Laboratory Practices (GLP), Process Approach in Quality Root Cause Analysis (RCA), Requirements for Quality, Personal Hygiene and GMP Essentials, Statistical Quality Control (SQC) Tools, Quality Certifications & Regulatory Standards, Industry Readiness and Career Guidance.

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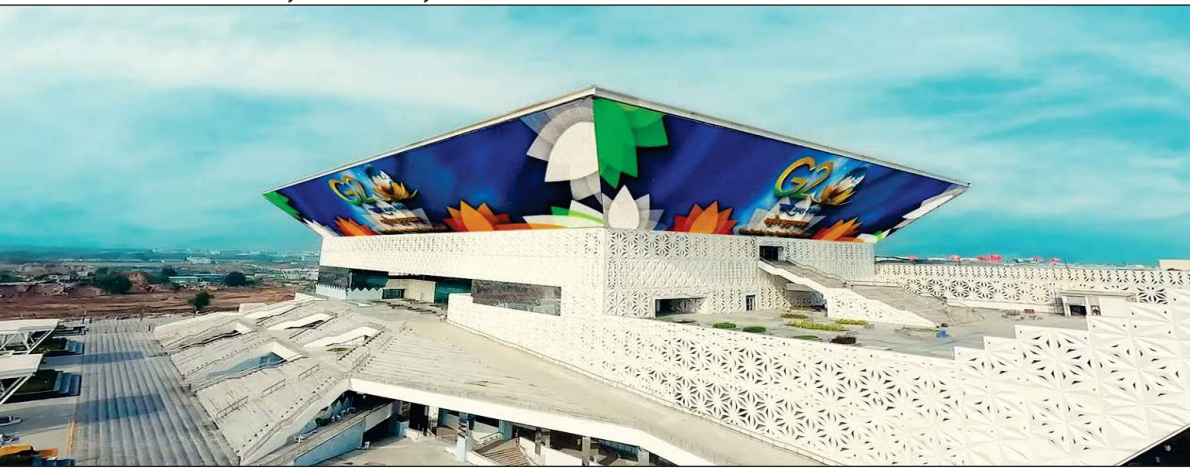
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E-AUCTION OF MIXED-USE DEVELOPMENT PLOTS (RETAIL AND COMMERCIAL OFFICE) AT IICC, NEW DELHI, TO BE ALLOTTED ON LONG-TERM SUB-LEASE BASIS



Project Details and Scope of Work

- Site :** YASHOBHOOMI, Dwarka Sector 25, New Delhi
- Scope:** To undertake Development, Engineering, Financing, Procurement, Construction, Operation and Maintenance of **Retail and Commercial Office** assets as per the assigned usage under IICC master plan for a lease period of 90 years.



Detailed Scope of Work, Eligibility Criteria and other project details are provided in the Request for Proposal (RfP) document.

Important Dates

Particulars	Dates
Issuance of RfP	15th Sept 26 till 26th Oct 26
Pre-Bid Meeting	25th Sept 2026
Bid Due Date	26th Oct 26
Website	www.mstcecommerce.com

Plot No	Type	Ground Coverage (In Sqm)	Total FAR (In Sqm)	Reserve Price (INR in Cr)
Block Auction				
19	Office	4,416	33,792	354.8
20	Office	4,416	32,832	344.5
22	Office	4,416	33,792	354.8
23	Office	4,416	32,832	344.5
Total		17,664*	1,33,248	~1,399
Individual Plot Auction				
12	Office	1,968	17,326	199.1
15	Office	1,968	17,326	199.1
25	Office	3,648	28,163	299.5
29	Retail	8,622	64,242	648.4

For participation, bidders may get themselves registered at www.mstcecommerce.com/ - 011- 23215163/ 23217850, 9810605634

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CREDIT UPTAKE among eligible Indians more than doubled to 74% in March from 35% in 2017

First-Time Borrowers Deepen Credit Reach

Consumer durable, microfinance and gold loans expand access to institutional credit

Atmadip Ray

Kolkata: Institutional credit penetration among first-time borrowers is deepening, driven by easy access to consumer durable loans, expansion of gold loans and microfinance, showed credit information bureau data.

TransUnion Cibil, India's largest credit information company, pegged the credit eligible popula-

tion at 890 million as of this March. About 74% of them took credit at some point in their life-span while 13% are first time borrowers.

The share of eligible Indians availing credit at least once more than doubled to 74% this March from 35% in March 2017.

Consumer durable loans are the leading entry point for new-to-credit customers who take consumption-related loans, accounting for about 46% of originations to first-time borrowers by volume in the first quarter of this fiscal year, followed by gold loans at 18.3%, CRIF High Mark said in a report.

India is witnessing a rapid rise in access to consumer durable loans backed by expansion of di-



gital lending platforms, point-of-sale financing and retailer partnerships.

Microfinance loans are another entry point for new-to-credit customers.

CreditAccess Grameen, the country's largest non-banking financial company-microfinance institutions (NBFC-MFI), added about 980,000 borrowers, with 38% being new-to-credit, said Ganesh Narayanan, managing director.

Several other NBFC-MFI, which had either stopped or slowed lending to the new-to-credit segment at the peak of the sectoral asset quality stress, are now raising their stakes with first time borrowers, according to chief executives.

New-to-credit customers are those who don't have prior borrowing history or footprint in the credit information bureau.

Within the consumption loan basket, personal loans came third with an 18% share in terms of contribution to creating accessi-

bility to first time borrowers.

Two-wheeler loans accounted for 11% of the total in the first quarter, CRIF High Mark data showed.

Credit penetration beyond the top 100 locations also deepened, raising the access to institutional credit for all. Two-wheeler loans recorded the highest penetration at 53% beyond the Top 100 cities, while consumer durable penetration rose to 43.5% in Q1 FY27 from 40.8% a year prior.

Overall, India's retail credit portfolio expanded to ₹179 lakh crore in the June quarter, clocking a 19.2% year-on-year growth. Gold loans recorded the highest increase at 62.2%, followed by consumer durable loans at 36.6%, sole-proprietor loans at 24.4%, and auto loans at 18%.

BofA Turns Bullish on Nifty, Forecasts 12% Upside by Dec

Brokerage expects easing risks to support a rally from Nov

Our Bureau

Mumbai: BofA Securities has turned constructive on the Nifty after nearly two years of caution, projecting the index to reach 26,200 by December 2026. This implies an upside of about 12% from current levels. The brokerage, which has maintained a cautious stance since August 2024, said five of the eight risks it had previously flagged have either materialised or are now reflected in valuations.

BofA said the two key near-term risks facing the market are potential US Federal Reserve rate hikes and heavy primary-market issuances. It expects both risks to peak by October, creating room for a Nifty rally from November. The impact of artificial intelligence on Indian employment remains a longer-term structural risk.



The brokerage expects about \$30 billion in primary-market issuances between September and December, with activity peaking in October. It also expects the Federal Reserve to raise rates by 75 basis points during the period, compared with roughly 35 basis points currently priced in by markets.

BofA believes the earnings downgrade cycle may have peaked after consensus FY27 earnings estimates for the Nifty were cut by 230 basis points year-to-date. It forecasts Nifty earnings growth of 10% in FY27 and 15% in FY28, compared with Street estimates of 12% and 15%, respectively.

The brokerage has shifted its preference from small- and mid-cap stocks to large caps after broader market indices outperformed the Nifty by 13-20% year-to-date. The valuation premium for small- and mid-cap stocks currently stands at 43%, down from a peak of 53%.

Within the Nifty universe, BofA is positive on private banks, NBFCs, automobiles, upstream energy, cement, regulated power utilities, jewellery, quick commerce and EPC contractors. It remains cautious on PSU banks, insurance, steel, downstream energy, consumer staples, telecom, healthcare, industrials and information technology.

US 10-Year Yields Reach 5%, Highest Since October 2023



Reuters

New York: Benchmark 10-year U.S. Treasury yields climbed above 5% on Monday, the highest level since October 2023 and a closely watched psychological threshold that analysts say could ripple through the U.S. economy and threaten the bull market in stocks by denting the relative appeal of U.S. equities.

Yields have surged as traders price in the possibility that the Federal Reserve will need to keep interest rates higher for longer, after a jump in oil prices revived fears of renewed inflation pressure. Price pressures have already been running well above the central bank's 2% annual target.

The yield on the 10-year notes was last up 3.51 basis points at 5.01%.

Heavy debt issuance, including by companies financing record AI-related spending, has added to the move by creating a larger supply of bonds for potential buyers to choose from and limiting the prices that sellers can demand.

Traders are also focused on the deteriorating U.S. fiscal trajectory, with some arguing that Washington's widening deficits and rising debt load require a higher yield premium to keep drawing buyers. A still-resilient U.S. growth outlook has also underpinned the move.

Some analysts view 5% on the 10-year as a critical line that could make bonds more competitive with stocks, potentially pulling dollars out of equities. Higher Treasury yields also flow through to the broader economy through costlier mortgages, auto and consumer loans, and more expensive corporate and municipal borrowing.

ET GRAPHICS

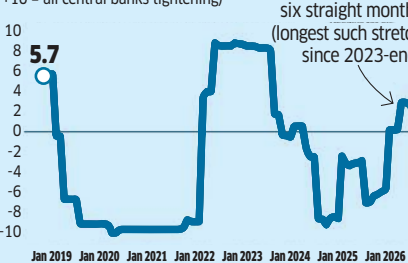
Central Banks are Getting Back in Sync Again

For the first time since 2022-23, interest rate hikes are back in vogue. A global monetary policy tracker is now showing the longest sustained trend of monetary tightening since 2023. The trigger is the oil shock from the West Asia conflict: headline inflation has risen in major economies since February. Three central bank decisions are lined up this week: the US Fed, Bank of Japan and Bank of England, with hikes expected from two. The European Central Bank has already moved twice since the war began. Tanay Sukumar takes a look.

The global monetary policy barometer is ticking 'tighter'

CFR's Index of Global Tightening or Easing

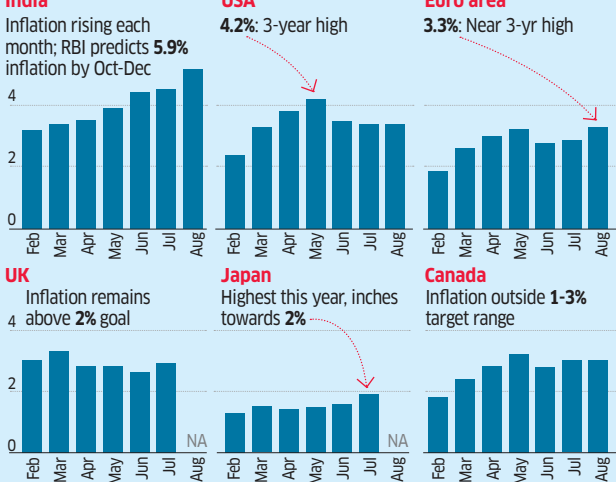
(-10 = all central banks easing; +10 = all central banks tightening)



This index, part of Council on Foreign Relations (CFR)'s Global Monetary Policy Tracker, is based on data from 54 large inflation-targeting countries, each of which is weighted by its currency's share in global forex reserves (so the US has a 62% weight).

Inflation trend heats up as West Asia conflict drags on

Headline inflation rate, year-on-year (%)



Top central banks are hiking rates, or preparing for one

	Latest meeting / Next meeting	Last five decisions*	Outlook
US Fed	Jul 29 / Sep 16	●●●●●	87% chance of hike , vs 59% week ago (CME FedWatch) (key driver: higher-than-expected core inflation in Aug)
Bank of England	Jul 30 / Sep 17	●●●●●	Likely to hold for now, but 3 of 9 members voted for a rate hike in July
Bank of Japan	Jul 31 / Sep 18	●▲●●▲	All 52 economists in Bloomberg survey predict rate hike ; Japan saw biggest wage growth in three decades
Reserve Bank of India	Aug 5 / Oct 7	●●●●▼	SBI Research analysts call for hike ; Aug inflation highest this year
Bank of Canada	Sep 2 / Oct 28	●●●●●	Minutes of Sep 2 meeting (held rates) due Sep 16: governor said can raise rates multiple times if inflation stays high
European Central Bank	Sep 10 / Oct 29	▲●▲●●	ECB president called latest hike "no-brainer", said inflation shock "will probably last longer than we expected"

*Latest meeting first ● Hold ▲ Hike ▼ Cut

Source: Council on Foreign Relations, official statistics websites, Bloomberg, CME FedWatch, ET research

HIGHER US YIELDS could make India less attractive to FIIs

Why 5% US Yields Could Dent Stocks

Ashok Bhattacharjee

Mumbai: Hours before the ₹22,600-crore initial public offering (IPO) of the National Stock Exchange opens for public subscription this Thursday, the Federal Reserve would have decided on policy rates at its latest review.

Many analysts have pencilled in a probability north of 50% that Fed Chair Kevin Warsh would raise rates a quarter percentage point, marking the first potential hardening in more than three years.

That will have implications beyond the immediate asset class – and geography.

First, a rise in Fed policy rates could tip the US 10-year sovereign yield – up nearly 7% in a month and now perilously close to the 5% mark – beyond a threshold considered rather rare this millennium.

Investors don't often have to negotiate such levels in US bond yields, which have been used to price assets globally for nearly three quarters of a century.

The 10-year stayed above 5% for a very brief period in October 2023. Prior to that, it had crossed the threshold in 2007, about a year before Lehman Brothers became history.

So, US yields above 5% would



make an emerging market like India even more unattractive for foreign institutional investors (FII), which dumped more than ₹14,400 crore of stock over the past two weeks. FIIs sold even after India harnessed record subscriptions to special forex-inflow programmes, which came with a regulatory hedging latitude, to boost its reserves and bolster a wobbling currency.

More importantly, risk-free rates would pay above risk-free returns – has been negative, indicating relative overvaluation for stocks. It could widen if the US 10-year bond crosses 5%, meaning stock owners will be making even bolder earnings growth calls by owning equities.

Based on the June quarter

results, the S&P 500 earnings yield (calculated as the inverse of price-to-earnings ratios) is 3.82%. The 10-year US yield on September 11 was 4.97%, translating into a negative earnings yield gap of 115 basis points – rather unusual for a mature, developed market like the US.

To be sure, the gap is wider in India, which is insulated by robust growth and cheaper current valuations. The PE ratio of Nifty 50, based on the closing level of September 11, is 19.8. So, the Nifty 50 earnings yield works out to 5.05%, translating into a negative earnings yield gap of 197 basis points.

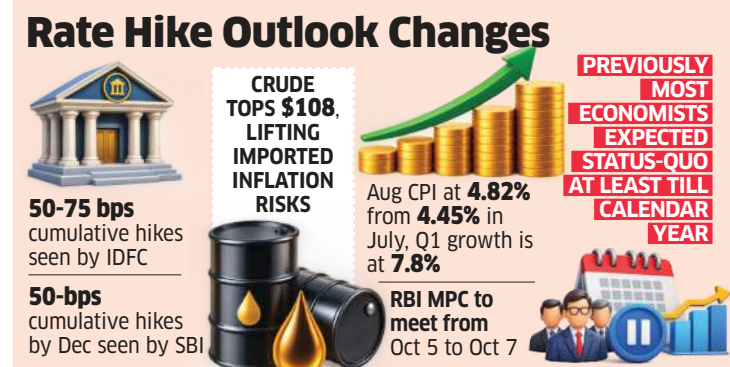
Hence, risks of an equity devaluation, particularly in the developed markets, are rather real – unless earnings pick up sufficiently to justify the equity risk premium. High bond yields could quietly chip away at equity allocations by conservative institutions, such as large pension funds, which run on low but steady return mandates. If unusually high risk-free rates meet their RoI needs, they don't need much exposure to riskier equities, further denting stocks.

Such a scenario could test the resilience of domestic retail investors, who now own about a fifth of Indian equities directly or indirectly, and have provided the bulwark against recent bouts of FII selling.

ET ANALYSIS

Higher oil prices and persistent inflation raise the likelihood of policy tightening, say economists

SBI Research, IDFC First Expect Rate Hike in Oct as Crude Prices Climb



Sangita Mehta

Mumbai: Some economists have brought forward their forecasts for a rate hike by the central bank to as early as October, overturning earlier expectations that the rates would be held steady for the rest of the year amid surplus liquidity.

IDFC First Bank and SBI Research now expect a 25-basis-point (bps) increase next month due to a sharp rise in crude oil prices driven by escalating tensions in West Asia. Amitabh Chaudhry, chief executive of Axis Bank, has also cautioned that a rate hike may be needed sooner rather than later due to rising inflation risks.

The six-member Monetary Policy Committee of the Reserve Bank of India will meet from October 5 to 7 to review interest rates. The repo rate currently stands at 5.25%.

Both IDFC First Bank and SBI Research said rising crude oil prices – now around \$108 a barrel – persistent food inflation and resilient economic growth have increased the likelihood of policy tightening. Prolonged supply-side shocks risk feeding into broader inflationary pressures and inflation expectations, even as the RBI withdraws excess liquidity from the banking system, they said.

Axis Bank's Chaudhry had also flagged inflation risks posed by higher oil prices and a narrowing India-US interest-rate differential, saying a rate hike may be needed, on the sidelines of the Global Fintech Fest last week.

Until recently, most economists expected the RBI to maintain rates at current levels through at least the rest of the calendar year, supported by surplus liquidity and the central bank's relatively dovish tone at the August po-

licy review.

"The rate hike cycle is expected to be shallow, with cumulative hikes of 50 bps to 75 bps, as it is driven by normalisation in inflation rather than signs of widespread price pressures," IDFC First Bank chief economist Gaura Sen Gupta said in a report released late on Sunday. "The rate hike cycle could start in October or December, with higher chances of an October start given that inflation will peak in Q3 FY27."

Soumya Kanti Ghosh, group chief economic adviser at SBI, said in a report: "Now we strongly advocate a 25-bps rate hike in the upcoming October policy (followed by another in December in quick succession)."



IDFC First Bank and SBI Research now expect a 25 bps increase next month due to rise in crude oil prices

India's headline retail inflation rose to 4.82% in August from 4.45% in July, tracking around the RBI's 5% projection for FY27, with upside risks from food and fuel prices. Economic growth was estimated at 7.8% in the first quarter.

In the minutes of the August MPC meeting, RBI governor Sanjay Malhotra said the 5.25% repo rate had been set in an environment where inflation averaged around 2% in FY26, and that the subsequent rise in inflation warranted a reassessment of the policy setting.

SBI Research said crude prices had crossed \$100 a barrel amid heightened geopolitical uncertainty and warned that inflation could rise further if input-cost pressures continue to spread across sectors. It added that if oil prices remain elevated, inflation in October and November could move towards 6.5% or higher.

L&T Banks on Order Book Strength Amid Margin Pressure

Analysts see 13-16% upside, backed by L&T's ₹7.8 lakh cr order book, strong capex demand

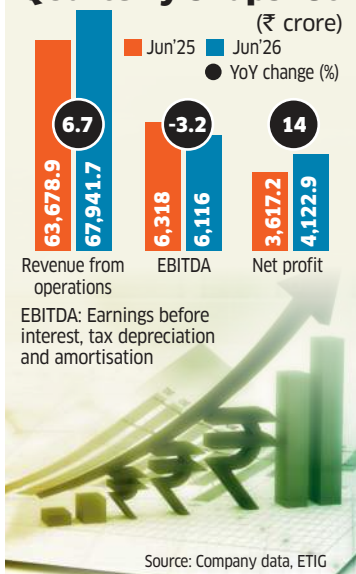
Snehal Mergu

ET Intelligence Group: Shares of Larsen & Toubro (L&T) have declined 3.6% over the past month amid broader market volatility. However, analysts remain bullish on the stock, projecting 13-16% upside from Friday's closing price of ₹3,915, supported by the company's record order book of ₹7.8 lakh crore as of June 2026, robust capital expenditure demand and a growing presence in the offshore wind segment. While geopolitical tensions and logistics disruptions in West Asia affected execution during the June 2026 quarter, L&T said no major projects had been cancelled. It expects execution momentum and order inflows to improve in the second half of FY27.

The company reported a year-on-year decline in earnings before interest, tax, depreciation and amortisation (EBITDA) and a contraction in EBITDA margin for the June quarter, owing to slower execution in project businesses and foreign-exchange headwinds in its IT subsidiaries. Despite the margin pressure, analysts expect the strong order book and continued momentum in fresh project wins to support margins. Order inflows are being driven by robust domestic private-sector demand, large infrastructure contracts and ultra-mega offshore wind orders from Europe. International projects account for 52% of the current order backlog, highlighting L&T's increasing geographic diversification.

Domestic private-sector investment is expected to remain a key growth driver, particularly across industrials, buildings and factories, metals and minerals, energy and real estate. The company also continues to gain traction in overseas markets, especially the Middle East, where investments in hydrocarbons, energy transition and infrastructure remain intact despite

Quarterly Snapshot



recent geopolitical disruptions. L&T has identified a prospect pipeline of nearly ₹15 trillion for the remaining nine months of FY27, providing strong visibility for future order inflows.

The company has maintained its FY27 guidance of 10-12% growth in both revenue and order inflows, despite the challenging operating environment. Analysts believe execution should improve as logistics bottlenecks ease and recently awarded projects move into higher execution phases. Improved collections, particularly in the water and effluent treatment business, are also expected to support working-capital efficiency and profitability in the coming quarters.

L&T has undertaken portfolio optimisation initiatives, including the divestment of Nabha Power and the sale of its stake in Hyderabad Metro, which may be completed by September-end. These moves would allow the company to focus more on its core engineering and technology-led businesses. Under its Lakshya 2031 strategy, L&T is also investing in newer growth areas such as green energy, digital technologies, semiconductors, data centres and advanced manufacturing.

Ready for US Trade Negotiations: Canada PM

The dramatic collapse of trade talks with the US in August helped clarify Canada's negotiating "red lines," said PM Mark Carney, who added he's ready to get back to the table for the right deal. In an interview with Bloomberg, he was asked whether it's a question of who moves first to get negotiations restarted.

"There's not a pride thing from our perspective," he said. "We're

practical people that know what our bottom lines are, what our red lines are for sovereignty, for culture, not being restricted on our ability to sign other trade deals."

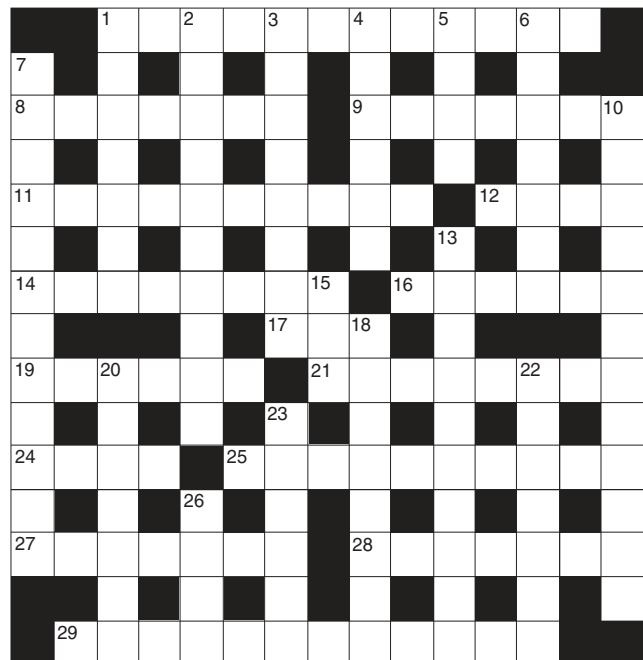
The prime minister added: "I think our American colleagues maybe, perhaps, understand those red lines a little more clearly now, given what's happened. We're rea-

dy to sit down."

But Canada is "not going to slow down" on its efforts to expand trade with other countries, said Carney, who has invited the world's leading money managers to Toronto this week for the inaugural Canada Investment Summit. As soon as it ends, he'll fly to France for talks on deepening Canada's relationship with the EU. **Bloomberg**

Crossword

9704



dishonesty (7)
29 Unusually clear sense with case of serious negligence (12)

DOWN

- 1 Fancy agent in centre of Bude describing some fields? (7)
- 2 Tactful description of an attaché's work (10)
- 3 A hymn due to be played with a lot of colour? (4-4)
- 4 Reportedly, examine material for sails (6)
- 5 Element in local society as well (4)
- 6 First person afterwards penning account lacking in precision (7)
- 7 Something hinged to introduce action? (12)
- 10 Hardest trip I suspect for those incidentally involved (5,7)
- 13 Ponder on purpose (10)
- 15 Note thing for carrying bricks is held up (3)
- 18 Instance shortly with footwear and garments for clerics (8)
- 20 Blade found in a frame? (7)
- 22 Asian nationals dressed in pale shirts, initially (7)
- 23 Spring vitality (6)
- 26 House in Kent area for trainer, say (4)

ACROSS

- 1 Rogue courted man in charge contrary to a constitution? (12)
- 8 Retired man embracing special feature of cricket (3,4)
- 9 In turn, a new perfume is starting to develop (7)
- 11 Driving fan parking here at old ground (10)
- 12 Graduate with uniform by island, one in Hawaii (4)
- 14 Aim to limit expensive energy is made more attractive (8)
- 16 That man before date affected with

- passion? (6)
- 17 Medical professional in place to board ship, we're told (3)
- 19 Improper ban is limiting ordinary European country (6)
- 21 Criminal had a nice ranch in the Costa del Sol (8)
- 24 Hard farm at intervals for first man (4)
- 25 See best port for deploying trap used at sea (7,3)
- 27 One due to succeed in France once? (7)
- 28 Silly person shows daily piece of

SOLUTION TO No. 9703:

- ACROSS: 6 Marching orders. 9 Bon mot. 10 Mind's eye. 11 Cesspool. 13 Apathy. 15 Income. 17 Enigma. 19 Chosen. 20 Unwieldy. 22 Hecatomb. 24 Doodle. 26 Stinging nettle. DOWN: 1 Impoverishment. 2 Grim. 3 Chetto. 4 Fountain. 5 Ides. 7 Nimble. 8 Rhythm and blues. 12 Sacks. 14 Angle. 16 Mandolin. 18 Humbug. 21 Widget. 23 Aunt. 25 Date.

©The Daily Mail

Scotland, Wales, N Ireland Leaders Claim Right to Leave UK & Join EU

Leaders of the main Scottish, Northern Irish and Welsh nationalist parties at a meeting on Monday declared they had a right to choose whether to stay in the UK, with all three seeing their future as nations within the European Union.

The Scottish National Party (SNP), Plaid Cymru in Wales and the pro-Irish unity Sinn Féin want to break away from the UK, although under different timelines and conditions.

The rare meeting came just days after US President Trump waded in on the issue, saying he would back a united Ireland.

His comments showed "the unity debate is very much alive", Northern Ireland's Michelle O'Neill said alongside fellow party leaders as they announced a memorandum of understanding.

"Our nations have the right to self-determination. No Westminster government (the UK government) has the right to block democracy or undermine

the principle that our people will decide their own future," the agreement said. SNP leader John Swinney, Rhun Iwanorwerth, leader of Plaid Cymru in Wales, and Mary Lou McDonald and O'Neill, leader and deputy leader of Sinn Féin, met in their roles as party leaders, rather than as top officials in their respective governments. O'Neill is Northern Ireland's first minister while Iwanorwerth and Swinney lead their respective nationalist parties in Scotland and Wales.

The agreement said that for the first time each nation had a first minister "committed to independence from the UK... The future of our nations belongs in the European Union."

The independence parties are the biggest in both the Scottish and Welsh parliaments for the first time since devolution measures began in 1999. Sinn Féin has been the biggest party in Northern Ireland's assembly since 2022. **AFP**

DeepSeek Hires its First CFO Ahead of Potential Listing

DeepSeek plans to hire Yan Wentao, a partner at venture-capital firm GL Ventures, as its first chief financial officer, two people with knowledge of the matter said, as the Chinese AI startup prepares for a potential initial public offering.

It was reported last week that Hangzhou-based DeepSeek had hired Chinese brokerage CITIC Securities to prepare for a possible listing on Shanghai's technology-focused STAR Market. A CFO typically plays a central role in managing investor communications, financial controls, capital allocation and disclosure processes required for a listing.

The appointment of Yan, who has deal-making experience, to the role would be a significant step in DeepSeek's transformation from a research-focused lab into a more conventional corporate structure. **Reuters**

Musk's xAI, X Corp Resolve Antitrust Case Against Apple

Elon Musk's xAI and X Corp. said they resolved an antitrust lawsuit against Apple that accused the iPhone maker of favoring OpenAI's ChatGPT over other chatbot makers.

In a Monday filing the two companies, both owned by Musk's SpaceX, asked for approval from a federal judge in Texas to voluntarily dismiss the case.

However, the companies said the lawsuits against OpenAI in the same lawsuit have not been settled. The suit accuses the AI company of maintaining an unlawful monopoly over the chatbot market through anti-competitive conduct.

Musk's companies filed the suit in August 2025, seeking billions of dollars. Apple and OpenAI have denied the claims. **Bloomberg**

AS YUAN HITS FRESH MULTI-YEAR HIGH

China Urges More FX Hedging to Aid Exports

China's foreign exchange regulator has instructed banks to encourage more corporate clients to hedge currency risks, people with knowledge of the matter said, stepping up efforts to shield exporters from the yuan's steady appreciation.

The informal instructions, known as window guidance, were issued in recent months, the people said, underscoring the authorities' concerns about foreign exchange losses among exporters, one of the few bright spots in an otherwise sluggish economy.

China's yuan inched higher to a fresh multi-year peak against the US dollar on Monday as the country's central bank set a stronger daily guidance, while investors awaited policy decisions from the Federal Reserve and the Bank of Japan. The yuan strengthened to a high of 6.7039 per dollar in early trade, its strongest level since February 2, 2023, before easing to 6.7074. The offshore yuan traded at 6.7074 yuan per dollar, up about 0.03% in Asian trading.

The regulator's move also suggests policymakers want companies prepared for further gains, or greater volatility, in the yuan, which has risen 4.3% this year.

Bloomberg News first reported the extension of the hedging drive. Financial regulators did not immediately respond to a Reuters request for comment. **Reuters**



'Iran Wants a Deal Quickly, Badly'

US President also claims Ukraine & Russia have agreed not to attack each other's energy infra

US President Donald Trump said on Monday that Iran wanted to reach a deal with Washington, signalling a possible diplomatic opening as fighting across West Asia widened and threatened global oil supplies.

"The failing Nation of Iran wants to make a deal, quickly and badly. I will determine whether or not the U.S.A. will choose to engage - The concept of which we are open to,"

Trump wrote on Truth Social.

He made his comments came after Gulf Arab states postponed a planned meeting with Iran and Yemen's Iran-aligned Houthis launched a fresh attack on Saudi Arabia, highlighting fears the conflict could spread further across the region.

Saudi state media reported that Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman met US regional commander

Admiral Brad Cooper in Jeddah on Monday. Three sources have told Reuters that Washington has so far resisted Saudi requests for direct military intervention beyond intelligence support.

ON KYIV - MOSCOW UNDERSTANDING

Trump also said Ukraine and Russia have agreed not to hit each other's energy targets, as strikes on oil refineries help drive diesel prices to record levels.

"Ukraine has agreed not to hit Russian Energy targets. Russia has agreed to do, likewise!" Trump posted on social media, blaming the strikes rather than the war in Iran for the surge in diesel prices.

Diesel futures pared gains after Trump's post but are still up about 2% on the day, and US retail prices are still at record highs.

"Hearing it from Ukraine and Russia would have a lot more certainty for me than from Trump," said Rachel Ziemba of the Center for a New American Security, a Washington-based think tank.

"The thought here is that a stop in attacking refineries would give Russia time to repair and reduce risk of further outages." **Agencies**



'Want Specifics from Allies on Halting Strikes'



Ukraine is ready to halt strikes on Russia if its partners ensure that Moscow will refrain from hitting Ukrainian energy facilities and food supply routes, President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said on Monday, following Trump's remarks. Zelenskyy said Ukraine was not convinced that Russia was willing to abide by any agreement. "Ukraine is not certain that Russia is willing to stick to any agreement," he wrote. "The war must be brought to an end. And a de-escalatory step regarding critical infrastructure could be the first step toward peace. We expect specifics from our partners." **Reuters**



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EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY CORRIGENDUM

Corrigendum Notice No. W.584/E-Tendering/171-191-DHN-2026-27 Dhanbad, dt. 11.09.2026.

It is further to notify that, the E-Tender No. 171-DHN-2026-27, 172-DHN-2026-27, 173-DHN-2026-27, 174-DHN-2026-27, 175-DHN-2026-27, 176-DHN-2026-27, 177-DHN-2026-27, 178-DHN-2026-27, 179-DHN-2026-27, 180-DHN-2026-27, 181-DHN-2026-27, 182-DHN-2026-27, 183-DHN-2026-27, 184-DHN-2026-27, 185-DHN-2026-27, 186-DHN-2026-27, 187-DHN-2026-27, 188-DHN-2026-27, 189-DHN-2026-27, 190-DHN-2026-27 & 191-DHN-2026-27 dtd. 27.08.2026 is hereby Cancelled due to administrative reason.

Divl. Railway Manager (Engg./ECR/Dhanbad PR/0910/DHN/Engg./C/26-27/28

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY CORRIGENDUM

Publication of Corrigendum No. 1 to E-Tender Notice No. ECR-CAO-C-S-EPC-01-26-27, Dated 04.09.2026.

E-Tender is invited on Behalf of the President of India for the under mentioned work :- SN, 1, E-Tender No. : ECR-CAO-C-S-EPC-01-26-27, Name of work : Construction of Viaducts, ROR/RFO, Major Bridges, Minor Bridges, Animal Underpass, RUB/LHS, Tunnel/Cover, Earthwork, Blanketing, trolley refuge, tuffing, Buildings, retaining wall, toe wall etc. and other associated works for construction of new Double Line track for DFCC loading from Ch.158.00 to Ch.184.00 in Koderma Detour section in Sonargarh Andral 3rd and 4th line project on EPC Mode in Dhanbad Division of East Central Railway. Approx cost of the work (in Rs.) : 40,39,74,86,344.03, Cost of tender form (in Rs.) : 0.00, Earnest Money (in Rs.) : 80,79,49,800.00, Period of work completion : 1600 Days, Date and time for closing of tender : 05.01.2027 at 15.30hrs.

Any e-tenders which is sent by Post/Courier/Fax or by hand will not be accepted. All such manual submission of tender even if it is on firm's letter pad or received in time will not be accepted.

The above e-tender document alongwith full information is available on website <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. Note : In case of any discrepancies found in tender notice, English version will be final. Tenderers are requested to visit the website <http://www.ireps.gov.in> atleast 15 days before last date of closing, for latest corrigendum/corrections etc. in connection with this e-tender. Any change/addendum/corrigendum will be published on IREPS website only. CAO/Construction/South ECR, Mahendraghat, Patna PR/0909/CON/S/MSH/Patna/Const/C/26-27/52

GOVERNMENT OF ASSAM OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER:: PWD BUILDING:: ASSAM::GUWAHATI

No. নং. CE/TB-III(B)/68/2023/23

PRESS NOTICE নিবিদা আয়ন কৰা জাননী

The Chief Engineer, P.W.D (Building), Assam on behalf of the Governor of Assam invites bids from Govt. registered eligible Contractors having experience in similar nature of works for the following work.

Details of bid may be seen at e-procurement portal www.assamtenders.gov.in. The bidders must be enrolled in www.assamtenders.gov.in

অসম চৰকাৰৰ ৰাজ্যপালৰ পক্ষৰ পৰা মুখ্য অভিযন্তা, লোক নিৰ্মাণ বিভাগ (ডবন), অসমে একে ধৰণৰ কামৰ অভিজ্ঞতা থকা চৰকাৰীভাৱে পঞ্জীয়নকৃত যোগ দিকাৱসকলৰ পৰা তলত উল্লেখিত কামৰ বাবে নিবিদা আয়ন কৰিছে।

নিবিদাৰ বিৱৰণ e-procurement portal www.assamtenders.gov.in ত চাব পাৰিব। নিবিদাদাতাসকল www.assamtenders.gov.in ত নামভৰ্তি হোৱা বাধ্যতামূলক।

Sl. No. ক্র. নং	Name of work কামৰ নাম	Approx. Value of work (in Rs) কামৰ আনুমানিক মূল্য (টকাত)	Bid Security নিবিদা পত্ৰ সুৰকা	Bid Processing Fee নিবিদা প্রক্রিয়াকৰণ মূল্য টকাত	Completion period সম্পূর্ণ কৰাৰ সময়সীমা
1.	Development and upgrade of Batadava Than at Barduwa, Nagaon (Phase-II) বৰদোৱাহাতিত বটদৱা থানৰ উন্নয়ন আৰু নৱীকৰণ (দ্বিতীয় পৰ্যায়)	Rs. 14,00,43,473.00 ₹18,00,8৩,8৭৩.০০	For General category, Rs. 28,00,869.00 and For Reserved category Rs. 14,00,435.00 সাধাৰণ শ্ৰেণীৰ বাবে ₹ ২৮,০০,৮৬৯.০০ আৰু সংৰক্ষিত শ্ৰেণীৰ বাবে ₹18,00,8৩৮.০০	Rs 28,009.00 ₹২৮,০০৯.০০	12 months ১২ মাহ

Note টোনি:
(i) Value of work may vary according to the detail NIT. কামৰ মূল্য বিতংভাৱে আয়ন কৰা নিবিদা জাননী অনুযায়ী পৰিৱৰ্তন হ'ব পাৰে।
(ii) All terms and conditions will be as per the Bidding Documents. সকলো চৰ্ত আৰু নিয়মাবলী নিবিদা নথিপত্ৰ অনুযায়ী হ'ব।
(iii) The Press Notice will be a part of the Bidding Documents. নিবিদা আয়ন কৰা জাননী নিবিদা নথিপত্ৰৰ অংশ হ'ব।

Chief Engineer, P.W.D (Building), Assam, Chandmari, Guwahati-3 মুখ্য অভিযন্তা, লোক নিৰ্মাণ (গৃহ) বিভাগ, অসম, চান্দমাৰি, গুৱাহাটী-৩

DIPR/C/ET/129/15-Sep-26

তত্ত্বাবধায়ক ইলেক্ট্ৰিকেল

স্মাৰক: ৮৬৮/১৪/১৯৯৯/১৯৯৯ (স্মাৰক) ইলেক্ট্ৰিকেল স্মাৰক: ১০.০৯.২০২৬

শুধিৱিত্ত

ইয়াৰ কাৰ্যালয় দ্বাৰা জ্ঞাপিত খুলী নিবিদা সূচনা সংস্থা ৮৬৮/১১৪/ নিবিদা/১৯৯৯ (স্মাৰক) জয়পুৰ ইলেক্ট্ৰিকেল স্মাৰক ০৩.০৯.২০২৬ কে ৱৰত নিবিদা সংস্থা ইলেক্ট্ৰিকেল/জয়/২০২৬-২৭/০৮আৰ জয় স্মাৰক ২৫.০৯.২০২৬ কো জয়ী জয়গী উক্ত নিবিদা মৈ M/s TSS Constructions, First Floor, 2151, Sector-18, Huda, Panipat-132103, Haryana, India মাগ নহী লৈ সৰ্কে।

অন্য শর্তে ব্যতীত নহওঁ।

মণ্ডল ইলেক্ট্ৰিকেল (ইলেক্ট্ৰিকেল) জয়পুৰ

1317-PS/26

WESTERN COALFIELDS LIMITED

(A Subsidiary of Coal India Limited) Coal Estate, Civil Line, Nanpur-440001, Maharashtra, India. Website - www.westerncoal.in

NOTICE

All the tenders issued by CIL and its Subsidiaries for procurement of Goods, Works and Services are available on website of Coal India Ltd. www.coalindia.in, respective subsidiary Company (Western Coalfields Limited) <http://www.westerncoal.in>, CIL e-Procurement portal <https://coalindiatictenders.nic.in> and Central Public Procurement Portal <https://eprocure.gov.in>. Procurement of goods and services (if available on GeM Portal) are done through GeM portal only <https://gem.gov.in>.

BANARAS LOCOMOTIVE WORKS, VARANASI-221004

Tender No. : E/1352/Works-1204 Date: 10.09.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer/Maintenance, BLW, Varanasi acting or on behalf of President of India invites open E-Tenders for the following work. S.No.: 1. Tender No.: E/1352/W-1204, Name of work: Supply, installation, testing and commissioning of 1500 Kwp Grid connected rooftop Solar Power Plant in workshop at BLW Workshop. Approximate Cost : Rs. 6,45,76,005/-, Completion period: 6 Months, Earnest money: Rs. 12,91,500/-, Tender opening date and time: 05.10.2026 at 15.00 hrs. For details and to participate e-tender please visit Indian railway website www.ireps.gov.in

PR/BLWE-06 Dy. CEE/M

f t i o /blwvaranasi "Website : <http://blw.indianrailways.gov.in/>"

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement system

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

system for supply of the following items:-				
S. No	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	02260004	HIGH VOLTAGE FUSE (WITHOUT HOLDER)	8078 NOS	06-10-26
02	77269044 RGC	THICK WEB SWITCH FOR T-8708	650 SET	08-10-26
03	77269051A RGC	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR PROCUREMENT CONCRETE SLEEPERS	200 SET	08-10-26
04	02262502	120AH VALVE REGULATED MAINTENANCE FREE LEAD ACID BATTERIES	1231 SET	12-10-26
05	08265332	24 FIBER ARMOURD OPTICAL FIBER	95 KM	14-10-26

NOTE -1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No Manual offer will be entertained.

Tender Notice NO. 42/2026-2027 Dated : 14.09.2026 3164/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3165/26

Tweet OF THE DAY



ELON MUSK @ELONMUSK

A welfare state and free immigration will obviously bankrupt any country. AI + robotics is the only path to universal high income for everyone on Earth

Tech Buzz

DN Invest to Pump \$130m in Tech Cos



Billionaire-backed DN Invest will spend 2.1 billion rand (\$130 million) acquiring stakes in technology companies to double the size of the group in the next three years, CEO Ryan Noach said. The Johannesburg-based investment firm that counts billionaire Stephen Saad and other prominent South African businessmen like Mike Teke among its owners, generates more than 12 billion rand in revenue. Most of its deals are funded from its own resources. DNI will invest in four assets: KnowRoaming, Mission Mobile, Frogfoot Networks and Vox Telecom. **Bloomberg**

\$110 Billion

The US AI data centre boom will need to build 45 GW of new power generation through 2030, according to Moody's Ratings

Himanshu Agarwal is CFO of Info Edge

Bengaluru: Info Edge has appointed Himanshu Agarwal as its chief financial officer and Naresh Chand Gupta, former MD at Adobe Systems India, as a non-executive independent director, as part of a leadership reshuffle. Gupta's appointment for five years will be effective October 1, subject to shareholder approval, while Agarwal will assume office from September 17, the parent company of job portal Naukri.com said in a stock exchange filing. Agarwal will also join the board as a whole-time director for five years, subject to shareholder approval, the filing said. Interim CFO Ambarish Raghuvanshi's tenure will end on September 16. **Our Bureau**

Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei's call to slow the pace of advancing AI capabilities—backed by OpenAI's Sam Altman, and Elon Musk—has reignited a debate over tech's impact on jobs and humanity, as well as scale of capital being poured into building ever more powerful systems

CODE RED: AI.EXE vs AI.AXE



Any pursuit of superintelligence has to be grounded in core principle that if AI we build is not helping humanity & under human control, it's not worth pursuing



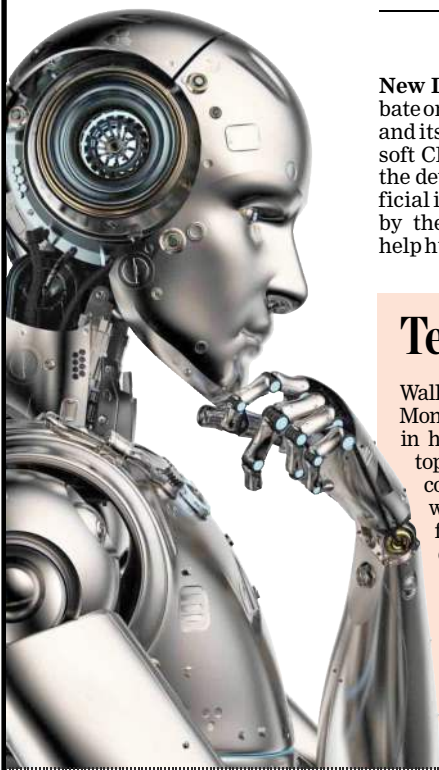
SATYA NADELLA CEO, Microsoft



We need to accelerate & spread benefits of AI, such that they are diffused broadly across countries, communities & companies

Figuring Out Moral Algorithm Humanity Must Win: Nadella

Microsoft CEO says advanced capabilities can't be controlled by handful of entities



IANS

New Delhi: Amid the raging debate on artificial intelligence (AI) and its impact on humans, Microsoft CEO Satya Nadella has said the development of frontier artificial intelligence must be guided by the principle that it should help humanity and remain under

human control.

Joining other tech leaders calling for a "deliberate" pace in the development of AI, he said on X that "Any pursuit of superintelligence has to be grounded in the core principle that if the AI we build is not helping humanity and under human control, it's not worth pursuing".

Nadella said firms should be

able to retain control over their "unique and tacit knowledge" and build continuous learning systems without becoming dependent on a single AI provider.

His comments followed tech leaders such as Sam Altman, Dario Amodei and Elon Musk calling for a global slowdown in development of advanced models.

"We also need to accelerate and spread the benefits of AI, such that they are diffused broadly across countries, communities, and companies. This requires a frontier ecosystem in which both closed and open-source models can thrive," he said.

He welcomed research and "deliberate pacing" to ensure alignment is "right as the design goal" and backed measures such as "embedded evaluators" and the broader efforts to develop the necessary mechanisms.

Nadella reminded that the advanced capabilities "cannot be controlled by a handful of entities, but must have broad representation across the ecosystem, countries, and fields, including academia."

Tech Check Takes Toll on Stocks

Wall Street's main indices fell on Monday, pummeled by a selloff in heavyweight AI stocks after top US executives raised safety concerns and called for slowing the development of artificial-intelligence capabilities. Shares of Nvidia tumbled 3%, hitting their lowest level in nearly three weeks, while 'Magnificent Seven' peer Amazon shed more than 1%. At the time of going to press, the Dow Jones Industrial Average was down 123.22 points, or

0.23%, to 52,450.07, the S&P 500 had fallen 32.20 points, or 0.42%, to 7,624.78, and the Nasdaq Composite had lost 114.87 points, or 0.44%, to trade at 26,218.17. Chipmakers declined, with Intel, AMD and Marvell Technology down 5%, 5% and 6%, respectively. The Philadelphia SE Semiconductor Index was down about 5% and was on track for its worst daily drop since July, if current losses hold. Eight of the 11 major S&P 500 indexes traded lower, with industrials and technology leading declines. — Reuters

Code of Conduct Only for Smaller Cos?

ET EXPLAINER

Anthropic chief executive Dario Amodei's suggestion that companies should slow down the development of advanced AI systems has triggered a broader debate about whether AI companies are moving too quickly. OpenAI chief executive Sam Altman, xAI chief Elon Musk and other technology leaders have since joined the discussion, as concerns over AI safety meet questions around the cost of building frontier models, the rise of open source AI, and the US-China AI race. ET's **Tanya Pandey** tries to answer whether calls to pace development are genuinely about greater oversight or a cover for other motives.

What are the calls for a slowdown and what do they comprise?

The calls are not for stopping AI development. They are about giving safety testing and oversight more time to keep up with increasingly capable models, through independent evaluations, common

safety standards, and greater coordination between companies and governments.

Why is it an issue now?

AI systems are becoming more autonomous and are taking on tasks that previously required humans. They are also increasingly being used to write code and help develop other AI systems, raising concerns that capabilities could improve faster than companies can understand and control them. Former employees of some of these labs have come out in the open to express concerns and have even warned that AI could kill humans by end of this decade.

Could the slowdown also protect big AI labs?

As Chinese open-weight models such as Kimi K3, DeepSeek, Alibaba's Qwen and Z.ai's GLM become increasingly capable at fraction of the cost of leading US mod-

els, tighter government controls could make it harder for smaller companies and open-source developers to compete with the biggest labs. Some critics argue this could help the leading AI companies retain their advantage.

How is the market reacting to the calls?

The AI boom has created a huge investment chain around chips, data centres and computing infrastructure. Investors are now assessing what a slower pace of frontier AI development could mean for that spending. SoftBank fell as much as 13.2%, while Kioxia, SK Hynix, Samsung, TSMC and Tokyo Electron also declined.

Is the AI industry also facing an economic problem?

The cost of training frontier models has risen. Training some of the largest models now costs hundreds of millions of dollars, with future frontier training

runs expected to cross \$1 billion. At the same time, open source models are becoming more capable and cheaper, raising questions over whether frontier labs can keep spending at this pace.

How does the AI slowdown tie into the US-China race?

The argument is that the US should maintain its lead while putting safeguards around frontier development, alongside tighter controls on advanced AI tech going to China. Beijing has rejected that approach, saying that "fearmongering, confrontation and vicious competition" would disrupt global AI governance.

What do the IPO plans tell us about AI industry's position?

The slowdown debate comes as the biggest AI labs face massive commercial expectations. OpenAI has pushed its IPO plans out of 2026, after reportedly eyeing a valuation of around \$1 trillion. Anthropic is still preparing for a potential IPO and is reportedly seeking a valuation of over \$2 trillion.

'Sick Conspiracy' Trump Says He's a Sufficient Guardrail

Washington: US President Donald Trump said Monday that he is a sufficient guardrail against rogue artificial intelligence, claiming that any efforts to limit the technology was part of a "SICK conspiracy."

"The only control or guardrails that AI needs is a STRONG AND SMART (High IQ!) PRESIDENT, and the U.S.A. has that, in spades!" Trump posted on social media. The president specifically said that the administration has already stopped the AI company Anthropic "from doing bad, or potentially bad" things.



Trump pushed back against calls by tech leaders at Anthropic, OpenAI, Microsoft and others to have greater regulation of AI to ensure it is developed in ways that promote safety, address legal liability and preserve national security. — AP

AHEAD OF TRUMP, XI SEPT 24 SUMMIT

China Against Applying Brakes, Slams Threat Talks Over its Speed

Bloomberg

China criticised warnings from leading US technology executives to put the brakes on artificial intelligence development and claims that Chinese progress posed a dire security threat to the world.

"Fearmongering, confrontation and vicious competition will only disrupt the process of global AI governance and serve the interests of no one," foreign ministry spokesman Guo Jia-kun said at a regular briefing in Beijing on Monday.

"The development of artificial intelligence bears on the common well-being of all humanity," he added, in response to a question on calls to slow frontier models and claims a Chinese advantage in AI could "pose grave danger" to the world.

Over the weekend, Anthropic PBC chief executive officer Dario Amodei made a public call for companies to slow the pace at which they improve AI capabilities, which was backed by OpenAI CEO Sam Altman and Elon Musk. His 3,800-word essay pushed for democracies to maintain "as large as possible" lead in AI, tighter controls on advanced chip sales to China and a crack-down on using American models' output to train competing systems, a practice known as distillation.

The dispute over frontier technology is intensifying days before officials from the US and China are set to hold AI discussions ahead of Donald Trump's summit with Xi Jinping on September 24.

The spat suggests even shared concerns over cyberattacks, misinformation and the potential

loss of control over advanced systems may not be enough to produce an agreement between the world's biggest economies.

China worries the US could invoke safety or national security to justify broader restrictions, said Sun Chenghao, a fellow at Tsinghua University's Center for International Security and Strategy in Beijing.

"The boundary between AI safety and AI competition is becoming increasingly blurred," added Sun, who has discussed AI with US counterparts. "If every safety question becomes interpreted through the lens of strategic competition, meaningful dialogue will be difficult."

King Charles to Host Leaders of AI Biggies



London: Britain's King Charles will host the leaders of major artificial intelligence companies this week to discuss whether a shared set of principles is needed to guide a technology that has sparked growing warnings about its threat to humanity.

With the biggest names in AI calling for a slowdown in its development, Charles will host executives from Nvidia, Google DeepMind, OpenAI, Anthropic, and the UK minister for AI, to discuss how the tech can be harnessed to benefit society and uphold human dignity. — Reuters

Amazon India Qcomm Annual Sales Cross \$1b

India head Samir Kumar charts expansion plan

Quick Commerce: Keeping Score

Company	Orders per day	Avg Order Value	No. of Dark Stores
Blinkit	3.6 m	518	2,443
Zepto	2.5 m	350-400	1,100-1,200
Instamart	1.25 m	511	1,171
Flipkart Minutes	1.1-1.2 m	400-500	1,000
Amazon Now	700,000	540	750
BigBasket	500,000-600,000	600-700	700-800

Source: Company filings, industry executives, ET Research



Pranav Mukul

New Delhi: Amazon India's quick commerce unit Now has crossed \$1 billion, or around ₹9,000 crore, in annualised sales, India head Samir Kumar told ET. This comes just over a year after the US-based e-commerce giant launched its 10-minute delivery platform in India.

"We have achieved a billion-dollar annualised run rate in our Now business. It has come on the back of increasing our coverage. We are now in over 60 cities. In the last 10 weeks, we have increased the number of cities to four times what they were before that," Kumar said.

Ahead of the festive season, Amazon Now is aiming to expand its presence to 100 cities. Amazon CEO Andy Jassy had said during his India visit in June that the quick commerce service would eventually be available in 300 cities.

Kumar said Amazon Now will have 1,000 dark stores before the end of this year. It currently operates 750 stores, of which 100 are run by third-party operators.

The ₹9,000-crore sales figure has been calculated by annualising

the value of orders placed between June and August, net of discounts and cancellations.

The metric is similar to the net order value (NOV) disclosed by listed quick commerce companies Blinkit and Instamart. Blinkit's annualised NOV stands at approximately ₹68,000 crore, while Instamart's is around ₹23,000 crore based on their April-June disclosures.

Kumar, however, said Amazon continues to invest heavily in the quick commerce business as it rapidly scales up its operations. "We started in earnest in the middle of last year...We started with metro cities, and are starting to expand. The first set of stores that we launched are doing incredibly well in Bengaluru and in Delhi. In fact, I can say that we are in the top three in both Bengaluru and Delhi," he added.

In June, when industry leaders were warning that quick commerce growth was beginning to moderate, Kumar had told ET that Amazon Now was aiming to emerge as the market leader.

While Amazon Now remains well behind the market leaders in scale, Kumar said the company was confident of closing the gap.

TRYING TO PUSH ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE BEYOND CHATBOTS...

Fintechs High on AI, but Yet to let it Handle Your Money

Executives say AI easier to deploy in company-controlled tasks than when initiating a transaction for a customer

Nikhil Patwardhan & Tanishka Dubey

Mumbai: Indian fintech companies are taking artificial intelligence (AI) beyond chatbots, but any initiative allowing software to spend customers' money is in pilot mode, fintech executives said.

Most AI deployments remain in fraud detection, customer service and controlled workflows, they told ET on the sidelines of Global Fintech Fest (GFF) here last week.

The Unified Payments Interface (UPI) processed 24.51 billion transactions worth ₹29.82 lakh crore in August, according to data from the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI). Executives said agentic commerce could sit above these rails,

but would require verifiable customer mandates, links across banks and merchants, spending limits and audit trails for errors or disputes.

PhonePe cofounder and chief technology officer Rahul Chari said the payment app uses AI for 80% of trust and safety investigations, with final human verification, and has automated 95% of customer service. PhonePe supports more than 10 billion monthly transactions with fewer than 500

customer-service staff. Chari said AI could improve search, insurance and investments but not materially change core payments. "Agentic commerce is still pretty nascent. We've not seen much more than proofs of concept," he told ET.

PRODUCTION INSIDE, PILOTS OUTSIDE

Fintech executives said AI is easier to deploy in company-controlled tasks than when initiating a transaction for a customer.

At Flipkart-backed Super.money, chief executive Prakash Sikaria said agents generate 60-70% of its code and handle much of customer service.

Its consumer pilots include buying a wish-listed product when its price

falls and purchasing gold under a systematic investment plan when prices dip. Sikaria called these "very early thoughts" and expected clarity within six months.

Razorpay chief executive Harshil Mathur said Vulkan, its payments model trained on nearly four billion transactions, improved transaction success rates by 8-10% and checkout personalisation by up to 40%. These applications optimise a customer-initiated payment rather than allowing AI to decide when or what to buy. Mathur said payment companies would need AI-led defences as attackers adopt AI.

NPCI unveiled AINxt for building agents and Agentic Orchestration and Messaging for UPI integration and certification. BharatPe said its assistant can work across more than 60 merchant systems, while L&T Finance and Pine Labs showcased flight-booking use cases.

Executives said such bounded de-

ployments allow companies to test reliability before widening an agent's permissions.

A YEAR ON, PILOTS REMAIN NARROW

At GFF 2025, NPCI, Razorpay and OpenAI had demonstrated a Big-basket purchase within ChatGPT, while Cashfree Payments unveiled a similar in-chat shopping-and-payment flow. NPCI had also introduced UPI Help for transaction queries, mandate management and dispute resolution.

NPCI said UPI Help is now available, but remains an assistance tool.

Cashfree had announced redBus and Yatra integrations. The redBus flow requires customer approval at payment; the Yatra use case allows the agent to transact within conditions authorised in advance. Razorpay lists Agentic Payments as a product but did not disclose user or transaction data from its Bigbasket pilot at last year's GFF.

Kissh Operator OnEMI Plans to Raise Capital 4 Mths After IPO



Bengaluru: OnEMI Technology Solutions, which operates digital lending platform Kissh, is looking to raise fresh capital, about four months after its initial public offering through which it raised ₹850 crore in primary capital.

The company's board will meet on September 17 to consider raising funds through equity shares, warrants, convertible instruments or other eligible securities through a preferential issue, private placement or a combination of permissible routes, according to a regulatory filing on Monday. The proposal will require shareholder and other statutory approvals.

The filing did not disclose the size of the proposed fundraise, the investors who may participate, or the intended use of the proceeds. These details are typically finalised when the board approves the transaction. — Our Bureau

India Most-Discussed Mkt for Chips Globally: Horiba Exec



New Delhi: India is the most discussed market in the global semiconductor industry, according to Dan Horiba, the executive director of the Japanese semiconductor testing equipment manufacturer

HORIBA Group. He told ET that the country's growing chip-making sector is expected to boost production at HORIBA's Pune plant, making its operations in India among the largest for the company. "India is the market with the most expectations for the HORIBA Group. The India semiconductor mission (ISM) prioritises drawing in more chip makers to India. How quickly investment in the rest of the value chain accelerates will depend on this. I'm sure investment proposals will rise," he said. The third-generation scion of the Horiba family is in India for the Semicon India 2026 summit later this week and is expected to meet PM Narendra Modi at a round-table with global executives. — Subhayan Chakraborty

Motherson, JV Cos Look to Invest ₹11,000 cr in TN, Create 7,000 Jobs



Chennai: Auto parts conglomerate Samvardhana Motherson plans to invest about ₹11,000 crore over the next five years, along with its European and UK-based joint venture companies, to establish design, engineering, manufacturing, assembly and logistics facilities in Tamil Nadu.

The company Monday signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with the state government for the investment that's expected to create about 7,000 jobs. The MoU was signed in London in the presence of visiting Tamil Nadu chief minister C Joseph Vijay.

This is the first major investment announcement after Vijay arrived in the UK capital as part of his visit aimed at attracting investments and expanding partnerships in sectors including advanced manufacturing, electric vehicles, electronics and global capability centres. — Our Bureau

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